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(54) **DYNAMIC AUDIO STORY GENERATION AND SOCIAL NETWORK**

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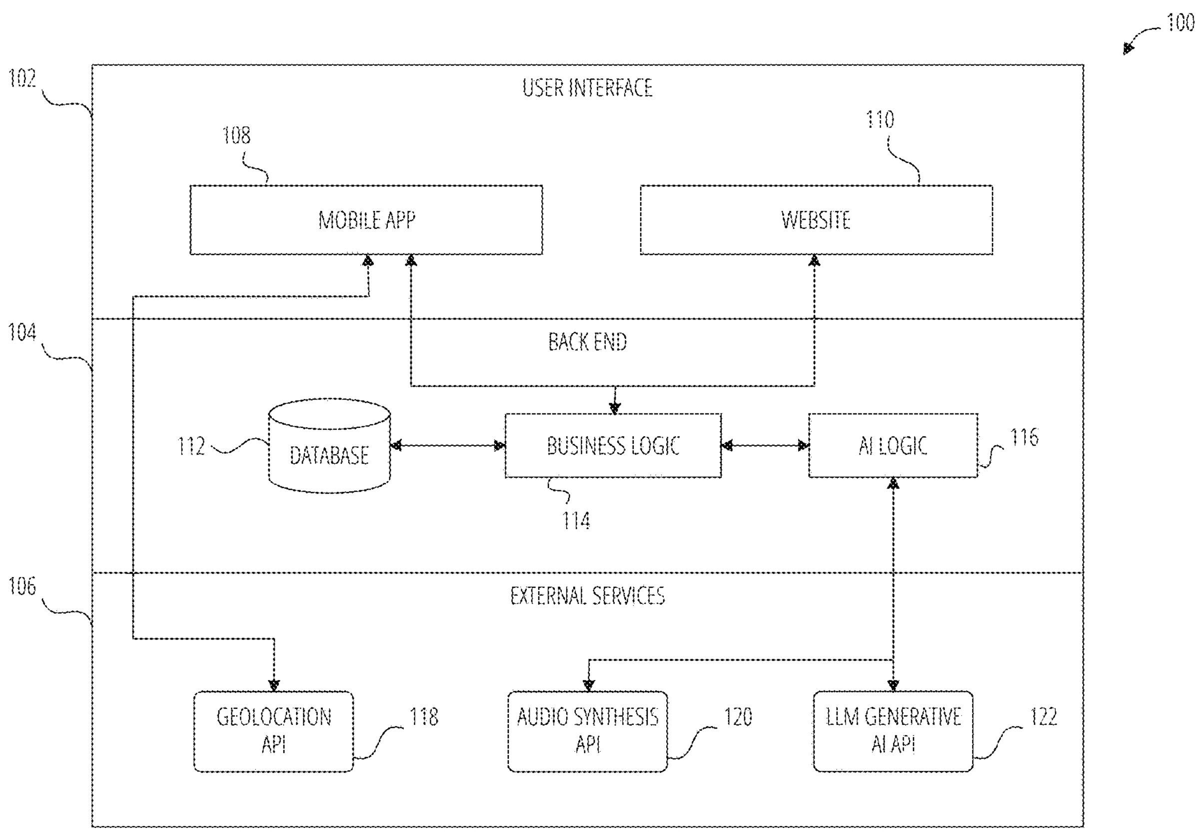
G06F 16/387	(2019.01)
G10L 13/08	(2013.01)

(52) **U.S. Cl.**

CPC ***G06F 40/20*** (2020.01); ***G06F 16/387*** (2019.01); ***G10L 13/08*** (2013.01)

(57) **ABSTRACT**

A system for creating highly personalized stories can receive location information associated with a user, which can be used to help identify one or more points of interest (POIs). One of these POIs can be manually or automatically selected. A user can select or the system can auto-select a host, which can represent a personality (e.g., a true crime podcaster, a documentarian, a comedian, an art historian, and the like). The POI and host information can be used to generate a custom prompt that can be fed into a large language model (LLM) generative AI to generate an output used to create a story transcript. The story transcript and host information can then be fed into an audio synthesis engine to generate synthesized audio used to create story audio content. The story audio content and optionally the story transcript can then be presented to the user.



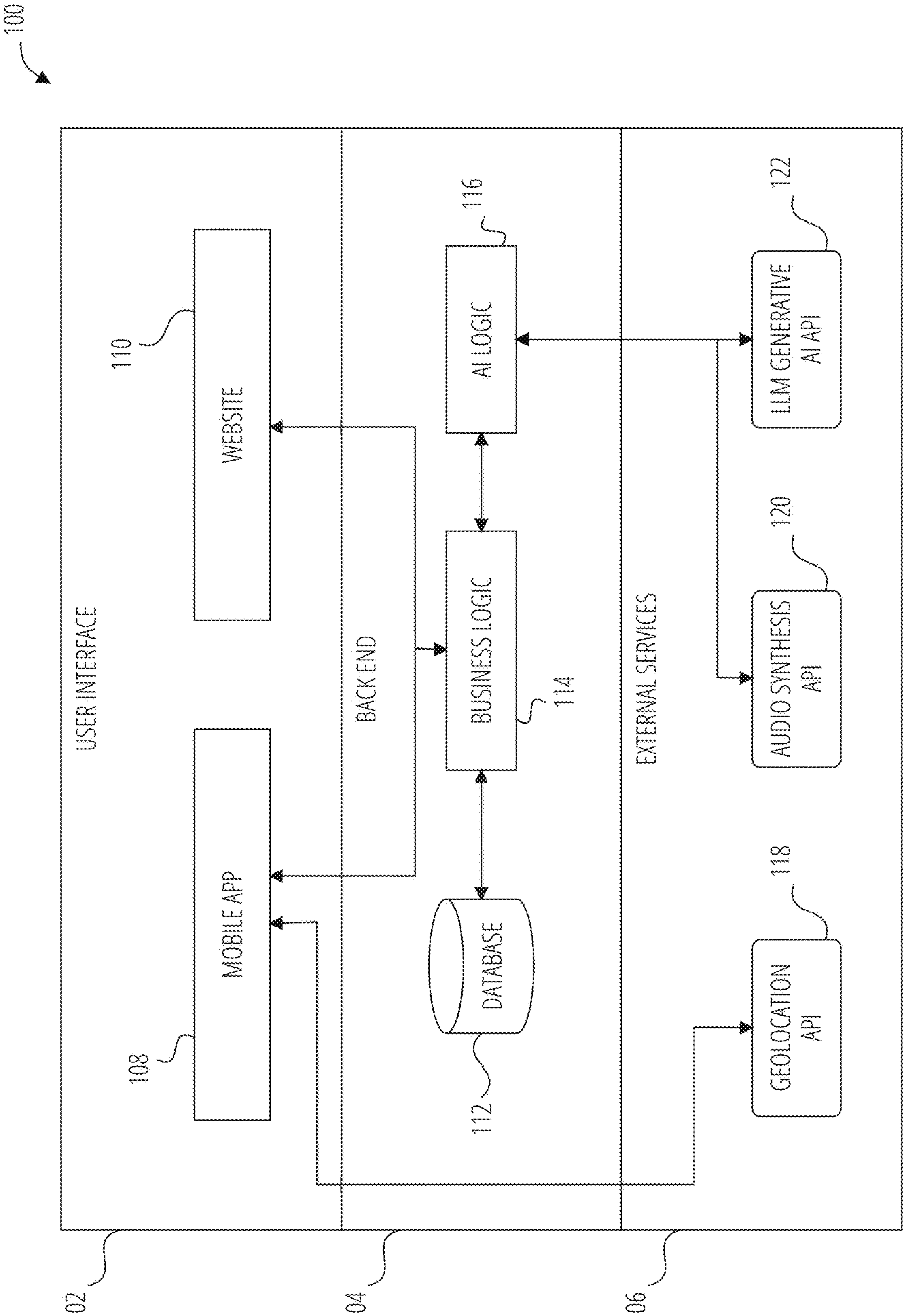

100
USER INTERFACE
110
WEBSITE
108
MOBILE APP
BACK END
116
AI LOGIC
BUSINESS LOGIC
114
DATABASE
112
EXTERNAL SERVICES
122
LLM GENERATIVE
AI API
120
AUDIO SYNTHESIS
API
118
GEOLOCATION
API
102
104
106

FIG. 1

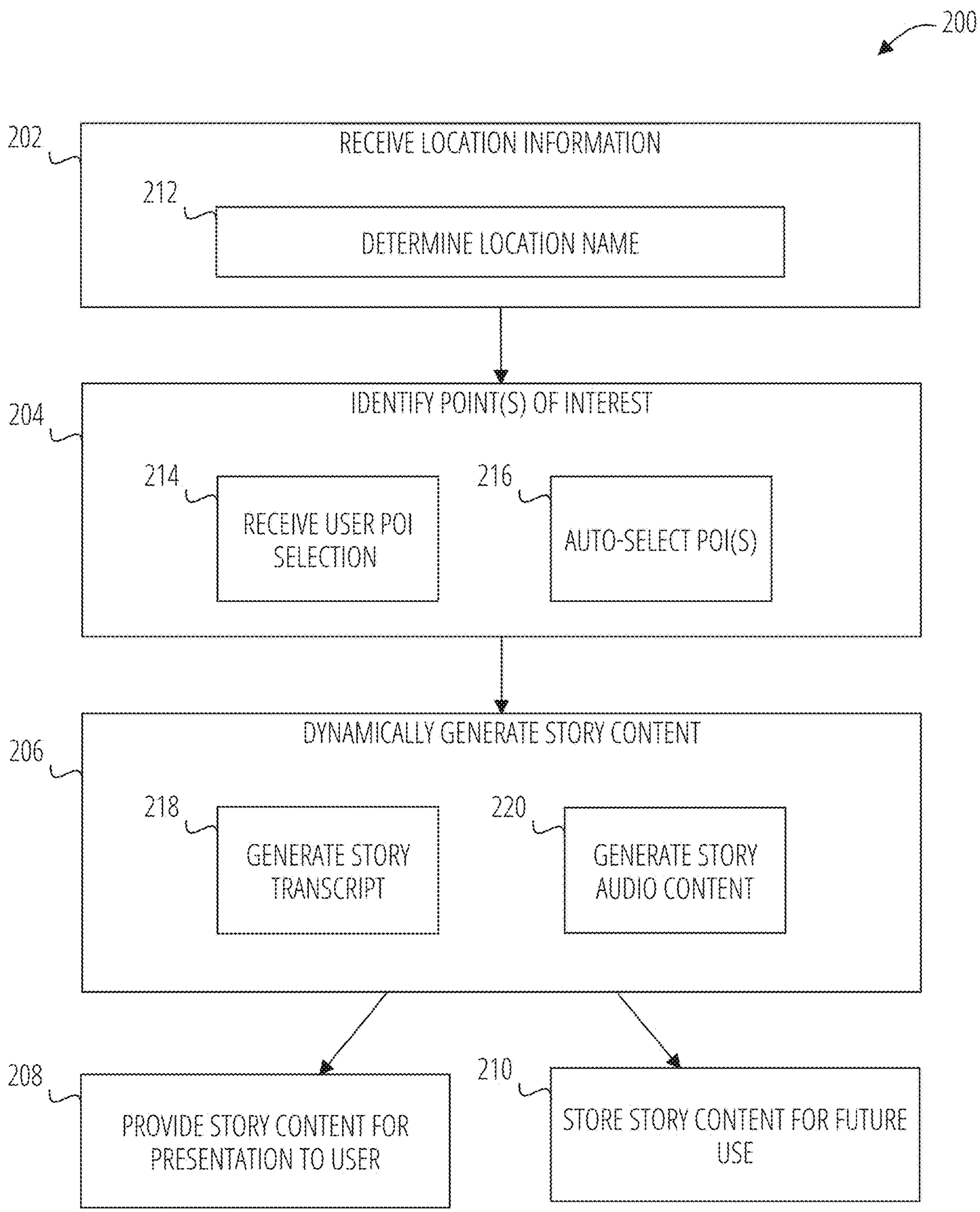

200
202
RECEIVE LOCATION INFORMATION
212
DETERMINE LOCATION NAME
204
IDENTIFY POINT(S) OF INTEREST
214
RECEIVE USER POI SELECTION
216
AUTO-SELECT POI(S)
206
DYNAMICALLY GENERATE STORY CONTENT
218
GENERATE STORY TRANSCRIPT
220
GENERATE STORY AUDIO CONTENT
208
PROVIDE STORY CONTENT FOR PRESENTATION TO USER
210
STORE STORY CONTENT FOR FUTURE USE

FIG. 2

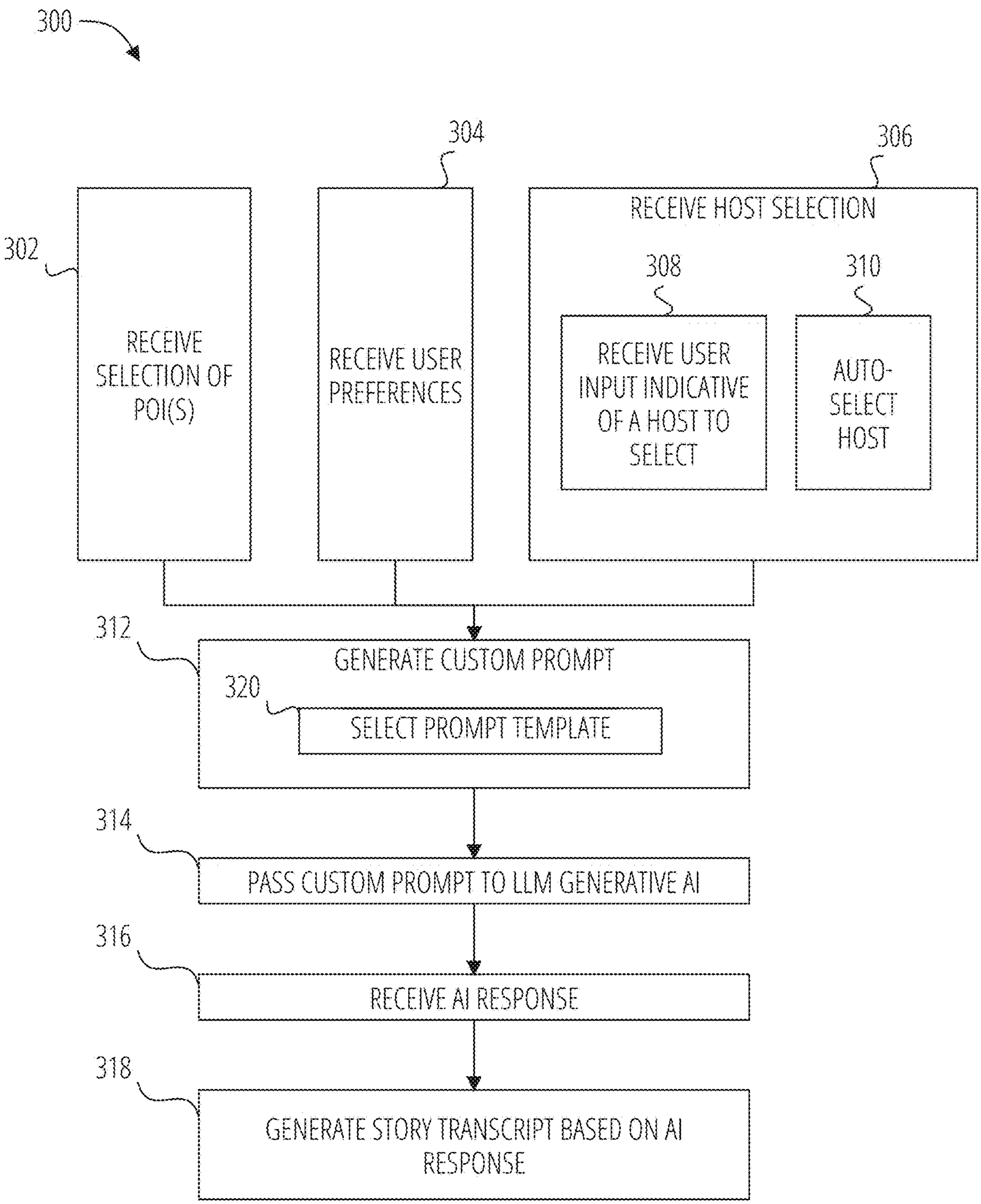

300
302
RECEIVE SELECTION OF POI(S)
304
RECEIVE USER PREFERENCES
306
RECEIVE HOST SELECTION
308
RECEIVE USER INPUT INDICATIVE OF A HOST TO SELECT
310
AUTO-SELECT HOST
312
GENERATE CUSTOM PROMPT
320
SELECT PROMPT TEMPLATE
314
PASS CUSTOM PROMPT TO LLM GENERATIVE AI
316
RECEIVE AI RESPONSE
318
GENERATE STORY TRANSCRIPT BASED ON AI RESPONSE

FIG. 3

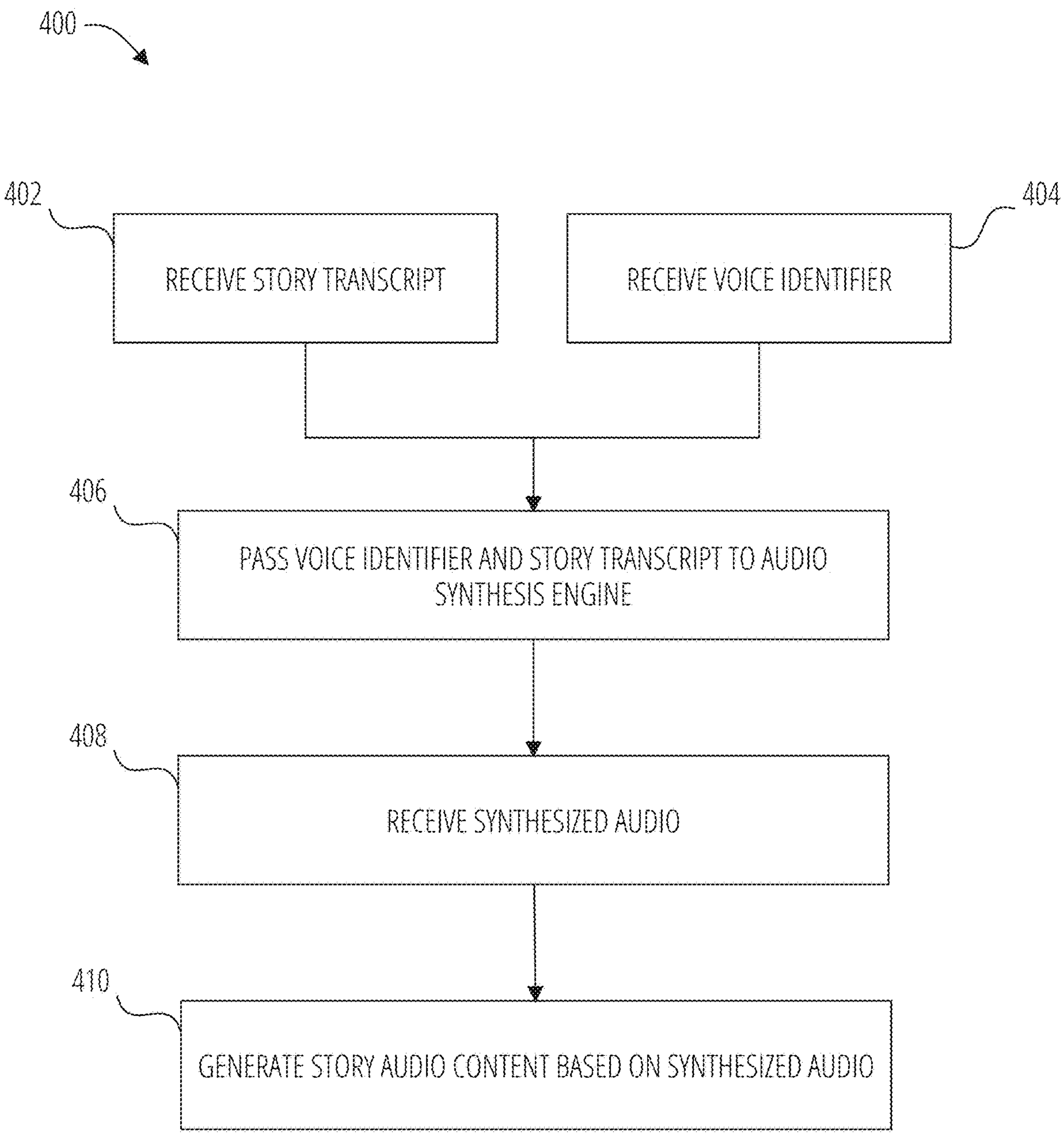

400
402
RECEIVE STORY TRANSCRIPT
404
RECEIVE VOICE IDENTIFIER
406
PASS VOICE IDENTIFIER AND STORY TRANSCRIPT TO AUDIO SYNTHESIS ENGINE
408
RECEIVE SYNTHESIZED AUDIO
410
GENERATE STORY AUDIO CONTENT BASED ON SYNTHESIZED AUDIO

FIG. 4

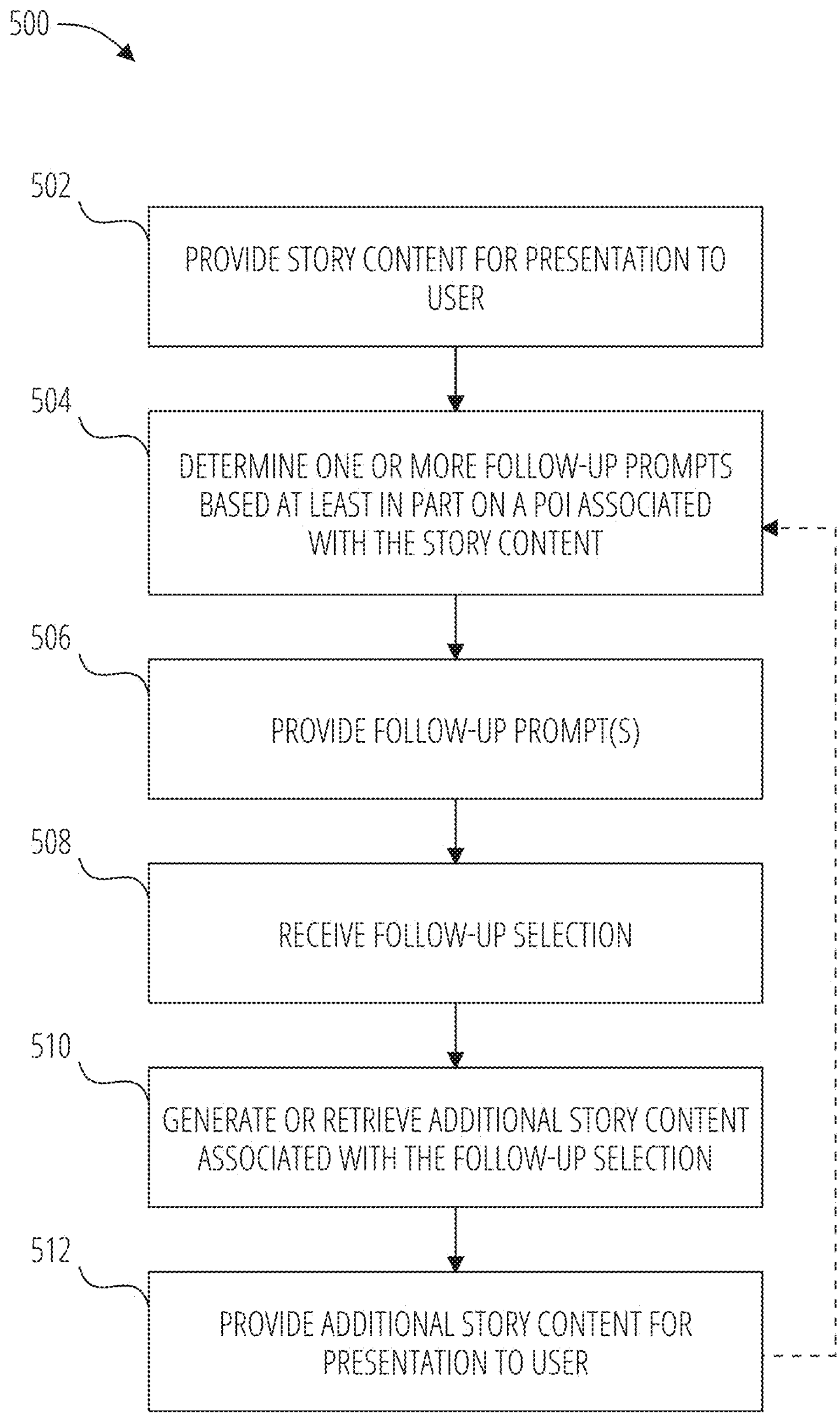

500
502
PROVIDE STORY CONTENT FOR PRESENTATION TO USER
504
DETERMINE ONE OR MORE FOLLOW-UP PROMPTS BASED AT LEAST IN PART ON A POI ASSOCIATED WITH THE STORY CONTENT
506
PROVIDE FOLLOW-UP PROMPT(S)
508
RECEIVE FOLLOW-UP SELECTION
510
GENERATE OR RETRIEVE ADDITIONAL STORY CONTENT ASSOCIATED WITH THE FOLLOW-UP SELECTION
512
PROVIDE ADDITIONAL STORY CONTENT FOR PRESENTATION TO USER

FIG. 5

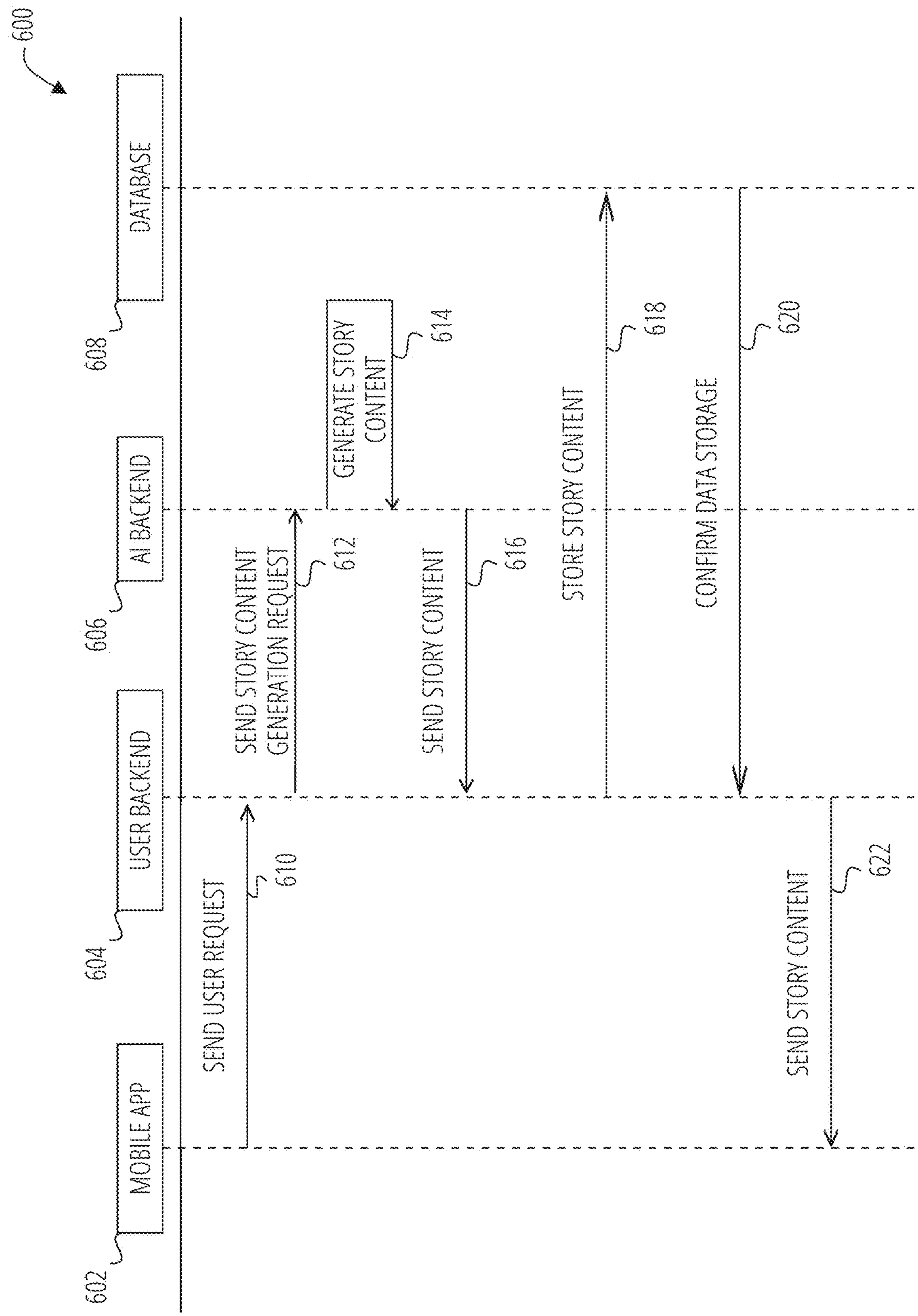

600
602
MOBILE APP
604
USER BACKEND
606
AI BACKEND
608
DATABASE
SEND USER REQUEST
610
SEND STORY CONTENT GENERATION REQUEST
612
GENERATE STORY CONTENT
614
SEND STORY CONTENT
616
STORE STORY CONTENT
618
CONFIRM DATA STORAGE
620
SEND STORY CONTENT
622

FIG. 6

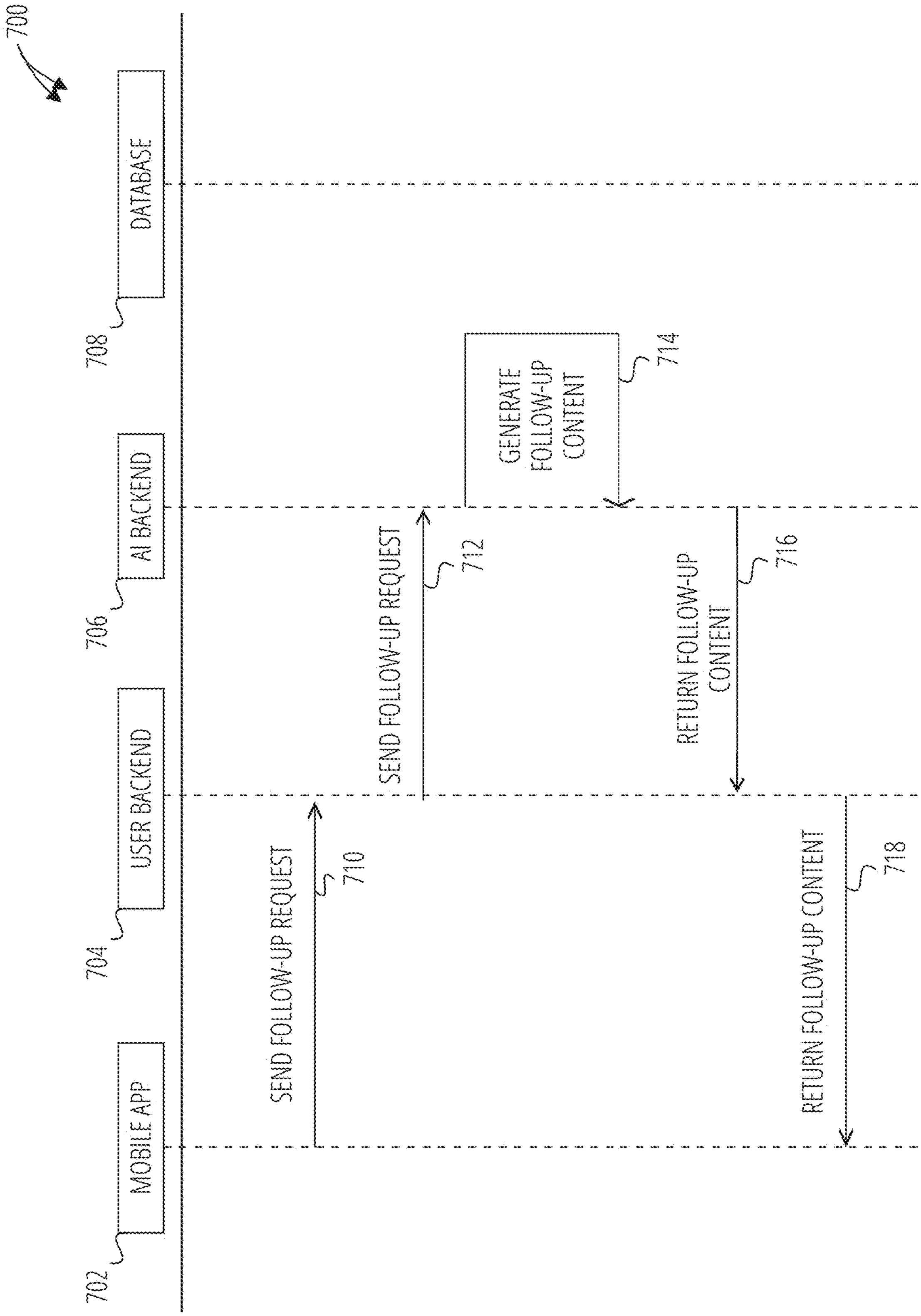

700
702
MOBILE APP
704
USER BACKEND
706
AI BACKEND
708
DATABASE
SEND FOLLOW-UP REQUEST
710
SEND FOLLOW-UP REQUEST
712
GENERATE FOLLOW-UP CONTENT
714
RETURN FOLLOW-UP CONTENT
716
RETURN FOLLOW-UP CONTENT
718

FIG. 7

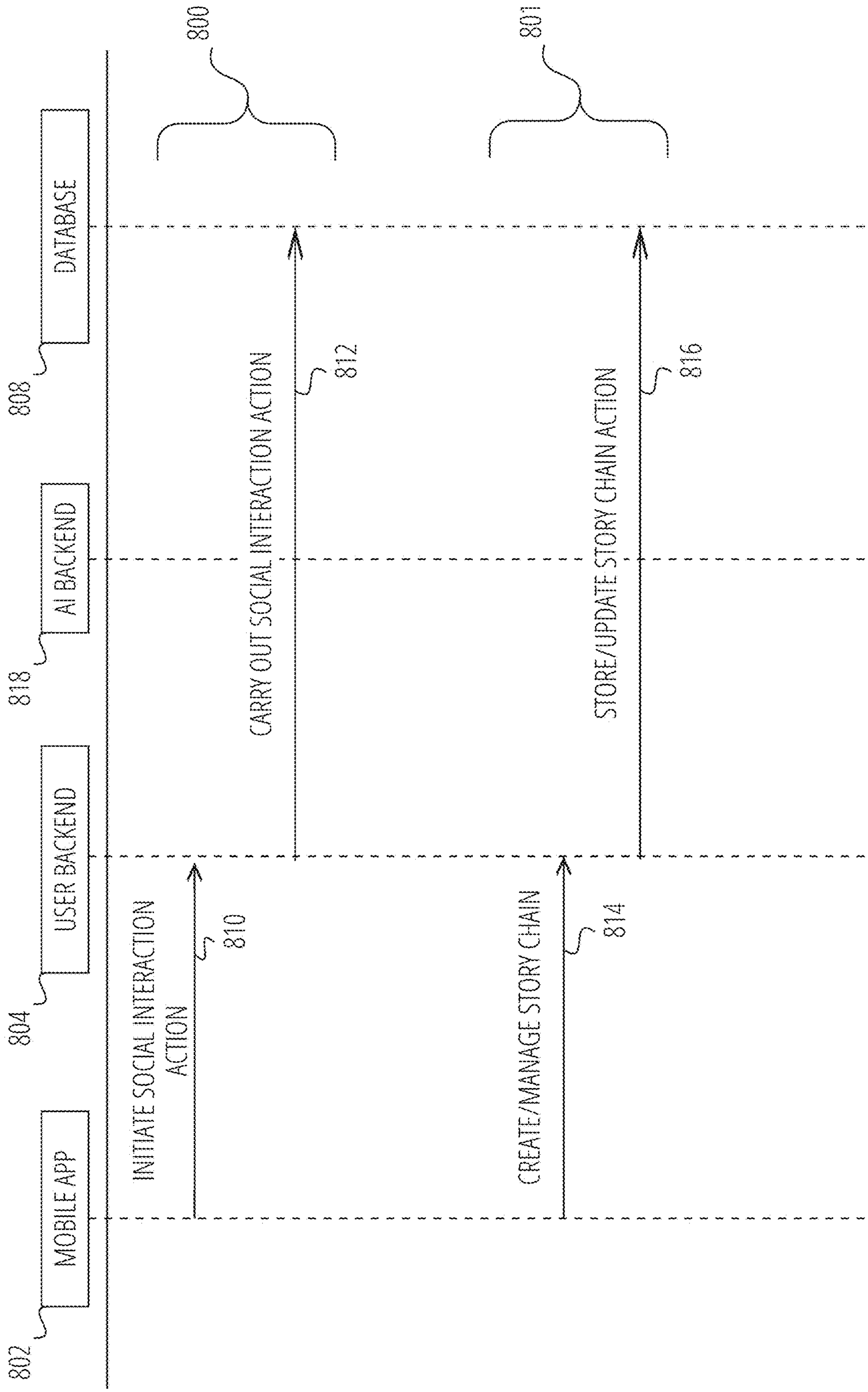

MOBILE APP
802
USER BACKEND
804
AI BACKEND
818
DATABASE
808
INITIATE SOCIAL INTERACTION ACTION
810
CARRY OUT SOCIAL INTERACTION ACTION
812
CREATE/MANAGE STORY CHAIN
814
STORE/UPDATE STORY CHAIN ACTION
816
800
801

FIG. 8

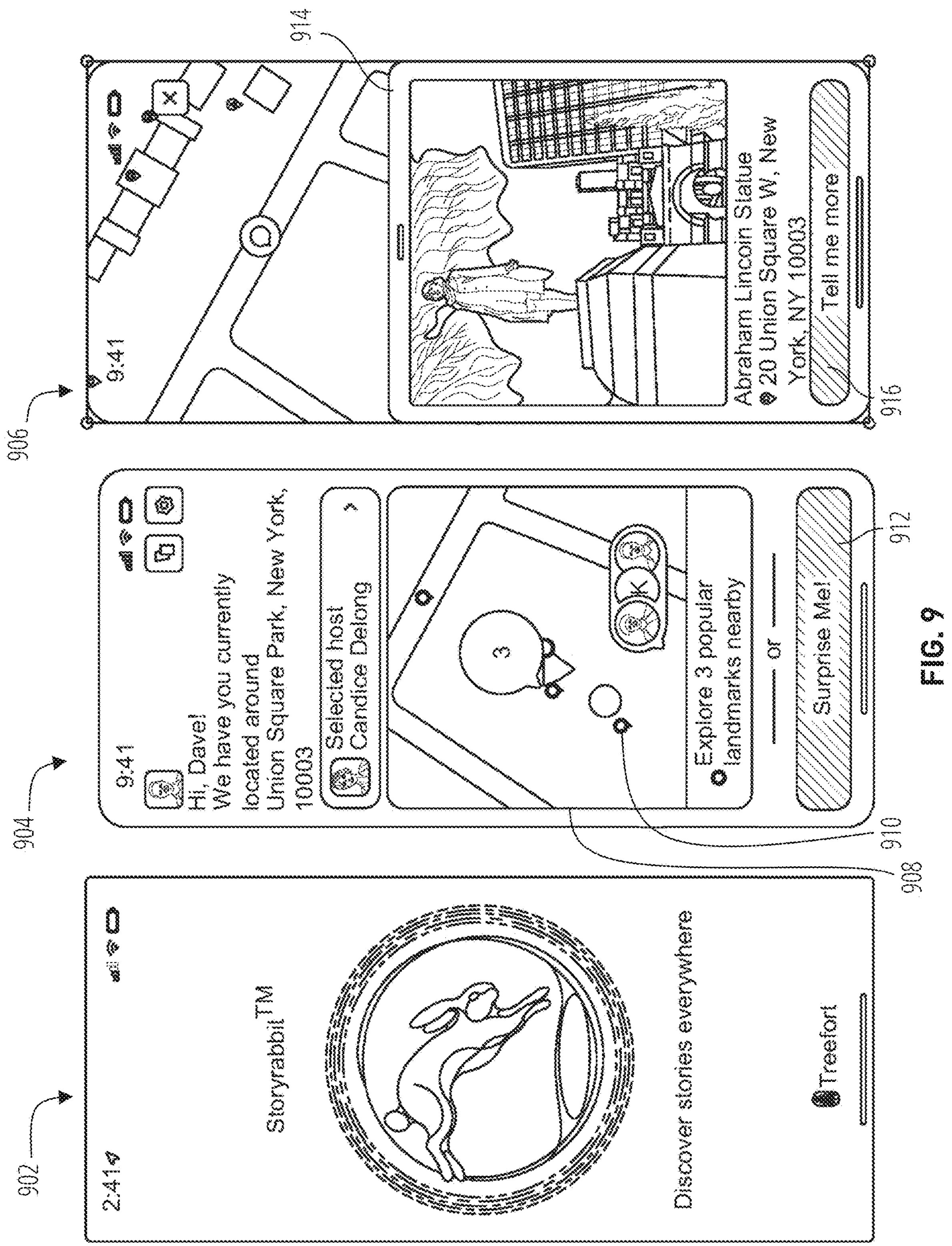

902
2:41
Storyrabbit™
Discover stories everywhere
Treefort
904
9:41
Hi, Dave!
We have you currently located around Union Square Park, New York, 10003
Selected host
Candice Delong
3
Explore 3 popular landmarks nearby
or
Surprise Me!
908
910
912
906
9:41
Abraham Lincoln Statue
20 Union Square W, New York, NY 10003
Tell me more
914
916

FIG. 9

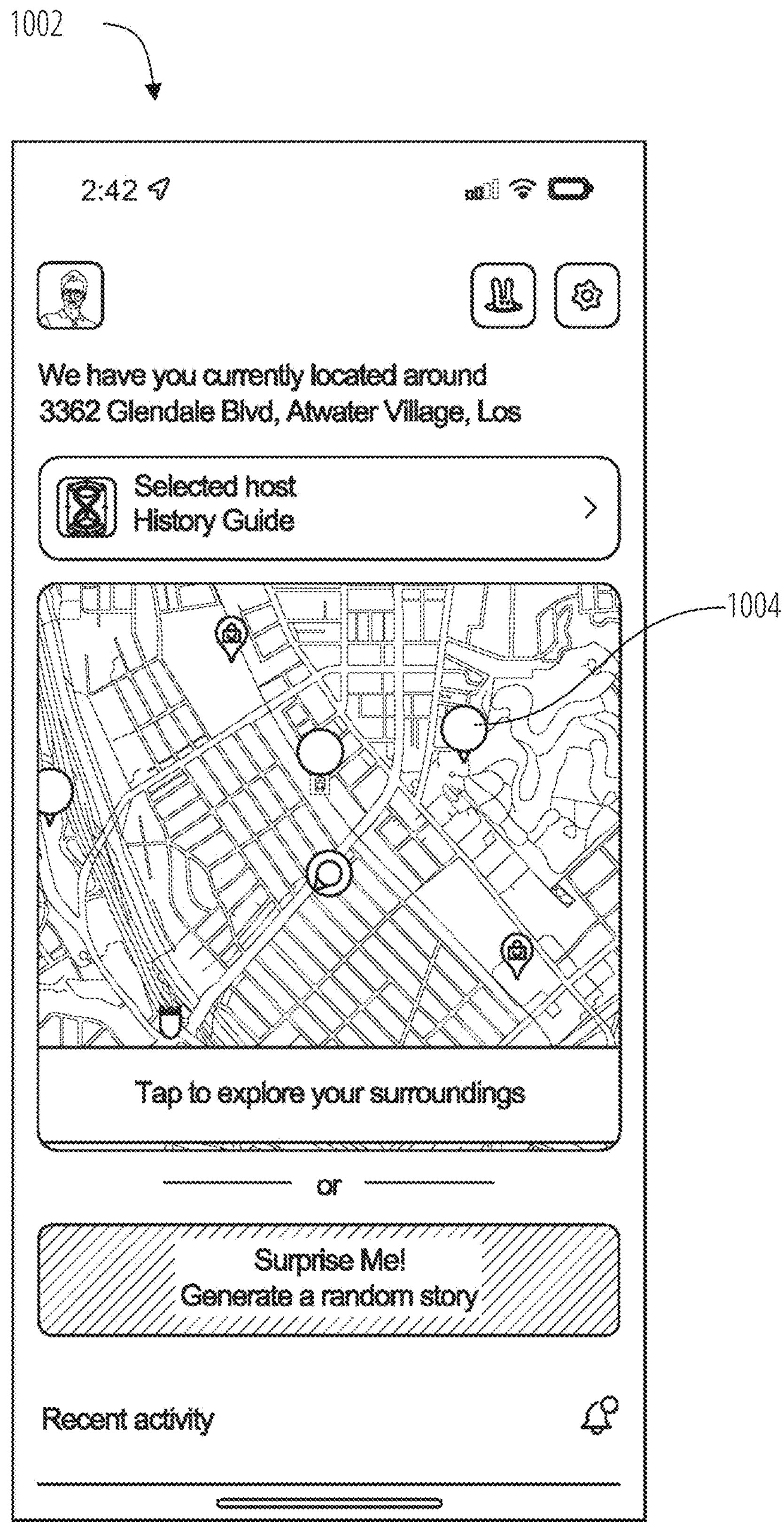

1002
2:42
We have you currently located around
3362 Glendale Blvd, Atwater Village, Los
Selected host
History Guide
1004
Tap to explore your surroundings
or
Surprise Me!
Generate a random story
Recent activity

FIG. 10

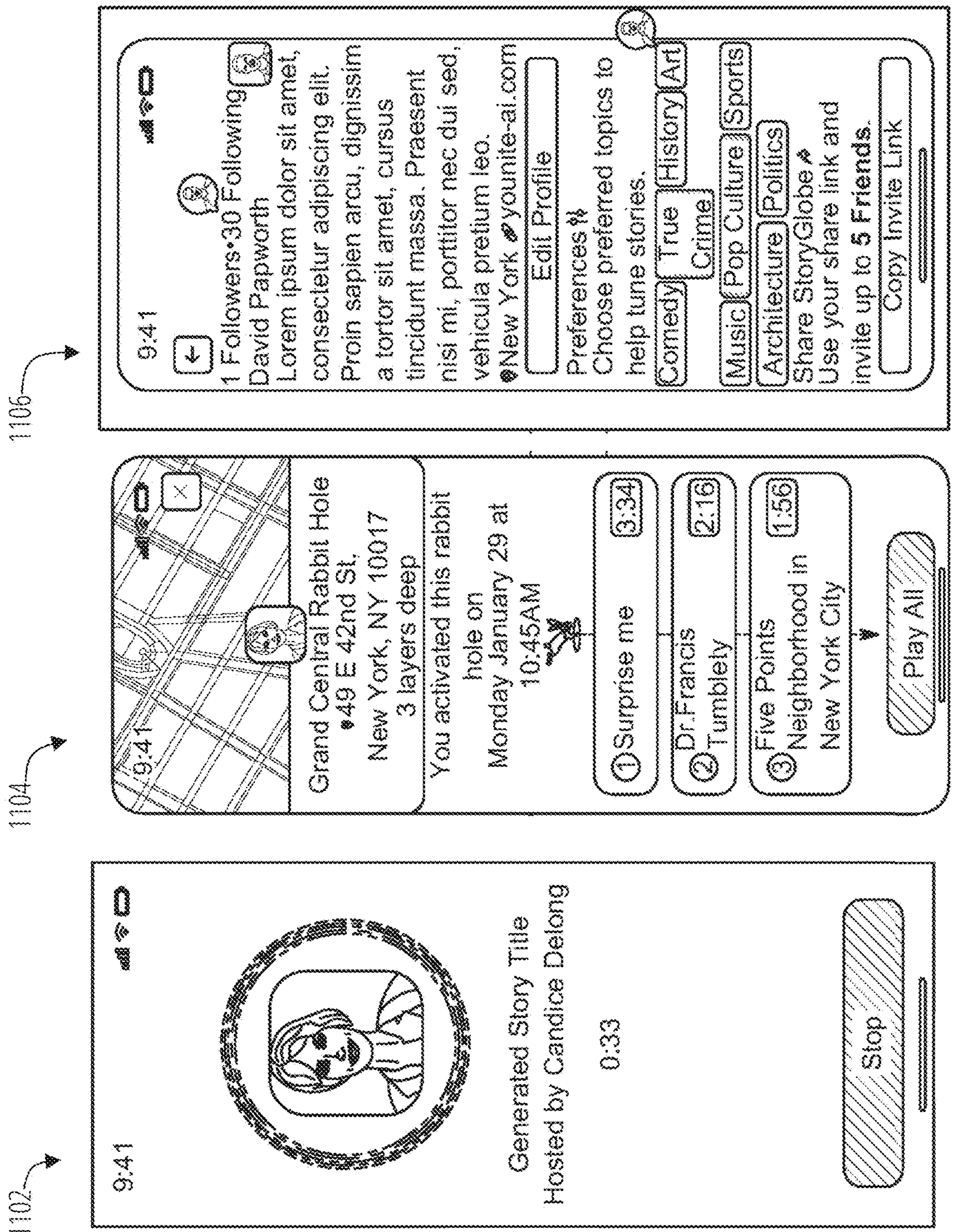

1102
9:41
Generated Story Title
Hosted by Candice Delong
0:33
Stop
1104
9:41
Grand Central Rabbit Hole
49 E 42nd St,
New York, NY 10017
3 layers deep
You activated this rabbit hole on Monday January 29 at 10:45AM
1 Surprise me 3:34
2 Dr.Francis Tumblety 2:16
3 Five Points Neighborhood in New York City 1:56
Play All
1106
9:41
1 Followers•30 Following
David Papworth
Lorem ipsum dolor sit amet, consectetur adipiscing elit. Proin sapien arcu, dignissim a tortor sit amet, cursus tincidunt massa. Praesent nisi mi, porttitor nec dui sed, vehicula pretium leo.
New York younite-ai.com
Edit Profile
Preferences
Choose preferred topics to help tune stories.
Comedy
True Crime
History
Art
Music
Pop Culture
Sports
Architecture
Politics
Share StoryGlobe
Use your share link and invite up to 5 Friends.
Copy Invite Link

FIG. 11

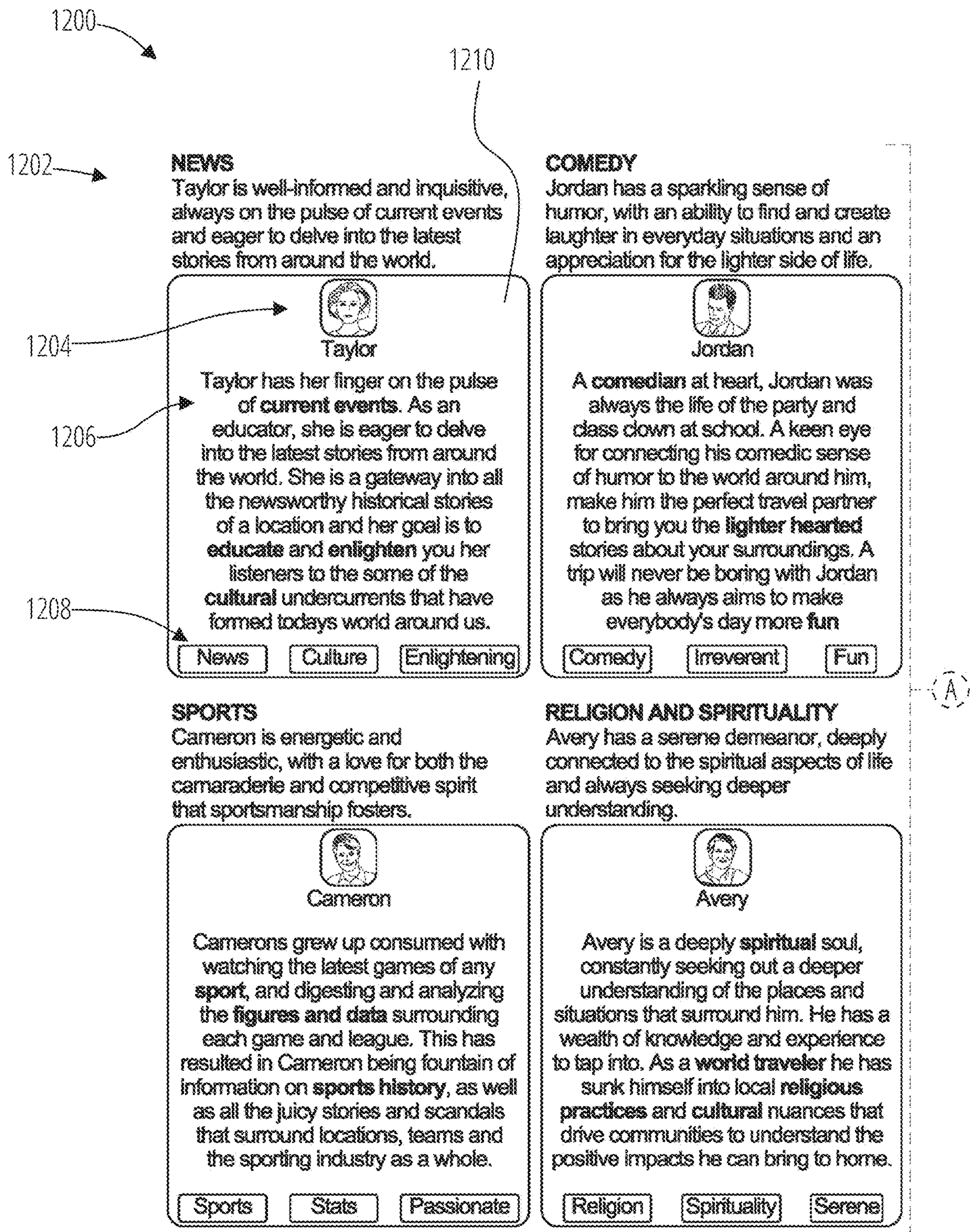

1200
1210
1202
NEWS
Taylor is well-informed and inquisitive, always on the pulse of current events and eager to delve into the latest stories from around the world.
1204
Taylor
1206
Taylor has her finger on the pulse of current events. As an educator, she is eager to delve into the latest stories from around the world. She is a gateway into all the newsworthy historical stories of a location and her goal is to educate and enlighten you her listeners to the some of the cultural undercurrents that have formed todays world around us.
1208
News
Culture
Enlightening
COMEDY
Jordan has a sparkling sense of humor, with an ability to find and create laughter in everyday situations and an appreciation for the lighter side of life.
Jordan
A comedian at heart, Jordan was always the life of the party and class clown at school. A keen eye for connecting his comedic sense of humor to the world around him, make him the perfect travel partner to bring you the lighter hearted stories about your surroundings. A trip will never be boring with Jordan as he always aims to make everybody's day more fun
Comedy
Irreverent
Fun
A
SPORTS
Cameron is energetic and enthusiastic, with a love for both the camaraderie and competitive spirit that sportsmanship fosters.
Cameron
Camerons grew up consumed with watching the latest games of any sport, and digesting and analyzing the figures and data surrounding each game and league. This has resulted in Cameron being fountain of information on sports history, as well as all the juicy stories and scandals that surround locations, teams and the sporting industry as a whole.
Sports
Stats
Passionate
RELIGION AND SPIRITUALITY
Avery has a serene demeanor, deeply connected to the spiritual aspects of life and always seeking deeper understanding.
Avery
Avery is a deeply spiritual soul, constantly seeking out a deeper understanding of the places and situations that surround him. He has a wealth of knowledge and experience to tap into. As a world traveler he has sunk himself into local religious practices and cultural nuances that drive communities to understand the positive impacts he can bring to home.
Religion
Spirituality
Serene

FIG. 12A

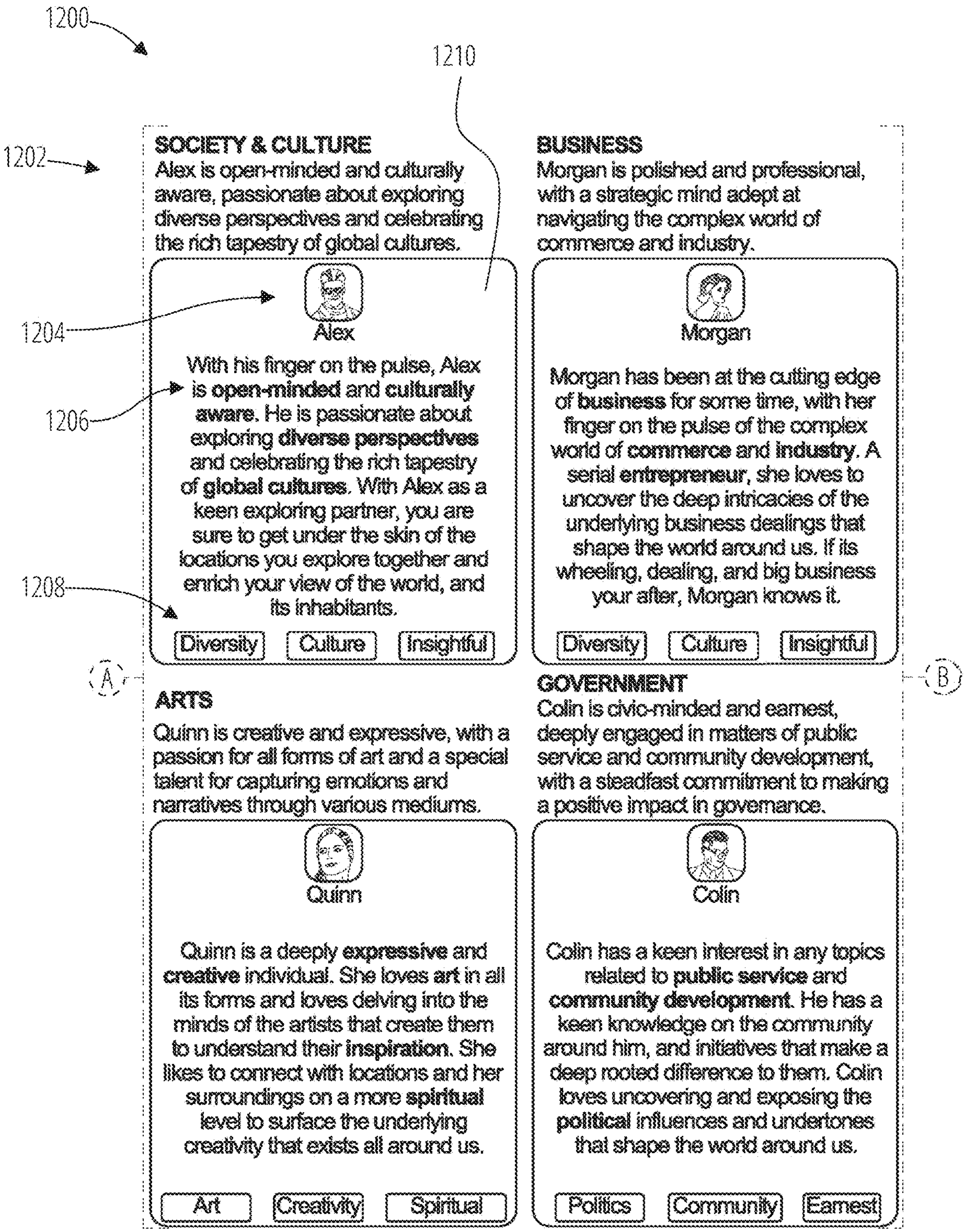

1200
1210
1202
SOCIETY & CULTURE
Alex is open-minded and culturally aware, passionate about exploring diverse perspectives and celebrating the rich tapestry of global cultures.
1204
Alex
With his finger on the pulse, Alex is open-minded and culturally aware. He is passionate about exploring diverse perspectives and celebrating the rich tapestry of global cultures. With Alex as a keen exploring partner, you are sure to get under the skin of the locations you explore together and enrich your view of the world, and its inhabitants.
1206
1208
Diversity
Culture
Insightful
BUSINESS
Morgan is polished and professional, with a strategic mind adept at navigating the complex world of commerce and industry.
Morgan
Morgan has been at the cutting edge of business for some time, with her finger on the pulse of the complex world of commerce and industry. A serial entrepreneur, she loves to uncover the deep intricacies of the underlying business dealings that shape the world around us. If its wheeling, dealing, and big business your after, Morgan knows it.
Diversity
Culture
Insightful
A
B
ARTS
Quinn is creative and expressive, with a passion for all forms of art and a special talent for capturing emotions and narratives through various mediums.
Quinn
Quinn is a deeply expressive and creative individual. She loves art in all its forms and loves delving into the minds of the artists that create them to understand their inspiration. She likes to connect with locations and her surroundings on a more spiritual level to surface the underlying creativity that exists all around us.
Art
Creativity
Spiritual
GOVERNMENT
Colin is civic-minded and earnest, deeply engaged in matters of public service and community development, with a steadfast commitment to making a positive impact in governance.
Colin
Colin has a keen interest in any topics related to public service and community development. He has a keen knowledge on the community around him, and initiatives that make a deep rooted difference to them. Colin loves uncovering and exposing the political influences and undertones that shape the world around us.
Politics
Community
Earnest

FIG. 12B

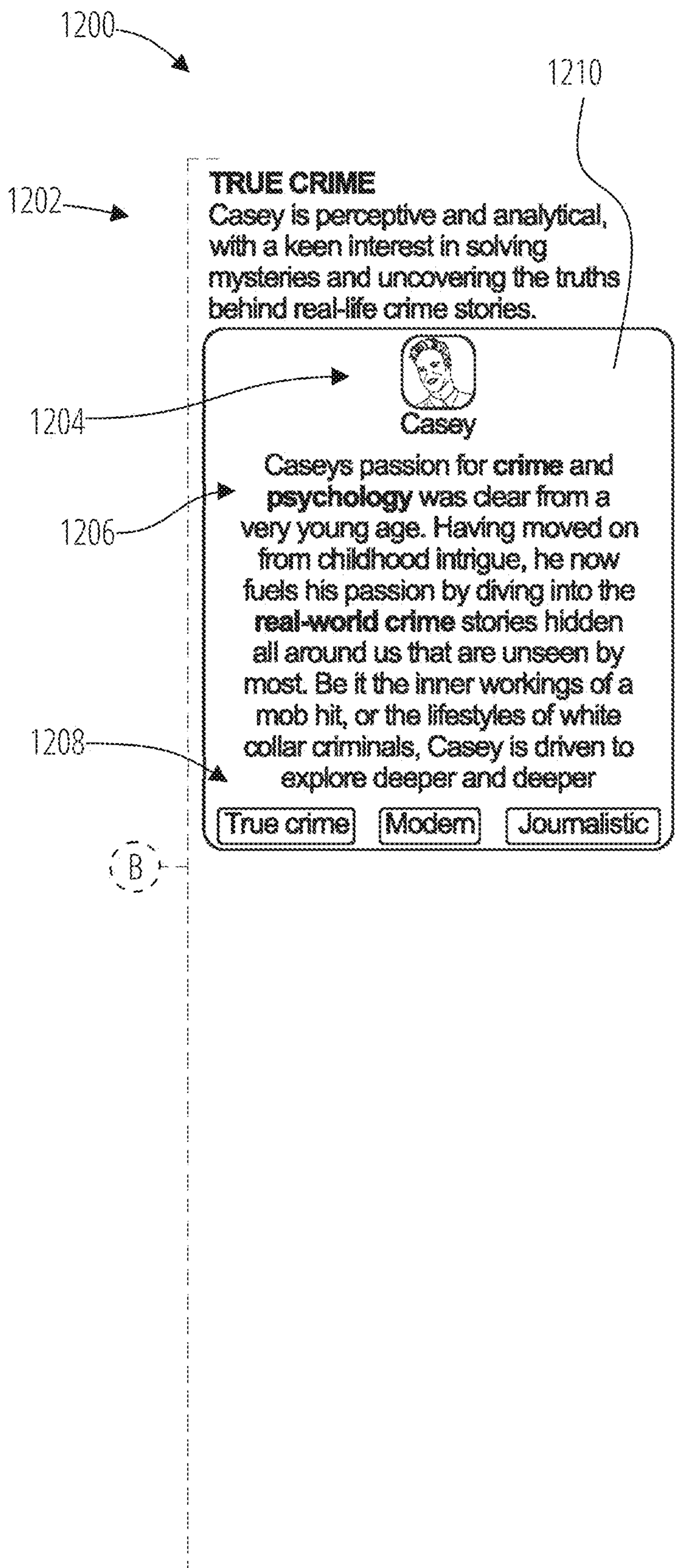

1200
1210
1202
TRUE CRIME
Casey is perceptive and analytical, with a keen interest in solving mysteries and uncovering the truths behind real-life crime stories.
1204
Casey
1206
Caseys passion for crime and psychology was clear from a very young age. Having moved on from childhood intrigue, he now fuels his passion by diving into the real-world crime stories hidden all around us that are unseen by most. Be it the inner workings of a mob hit, or the lifestyles of white collar criminals, Casey is driven to explore deeper and deeper
1208
True crime
Modern
Journalistic
B

FIG. 12C

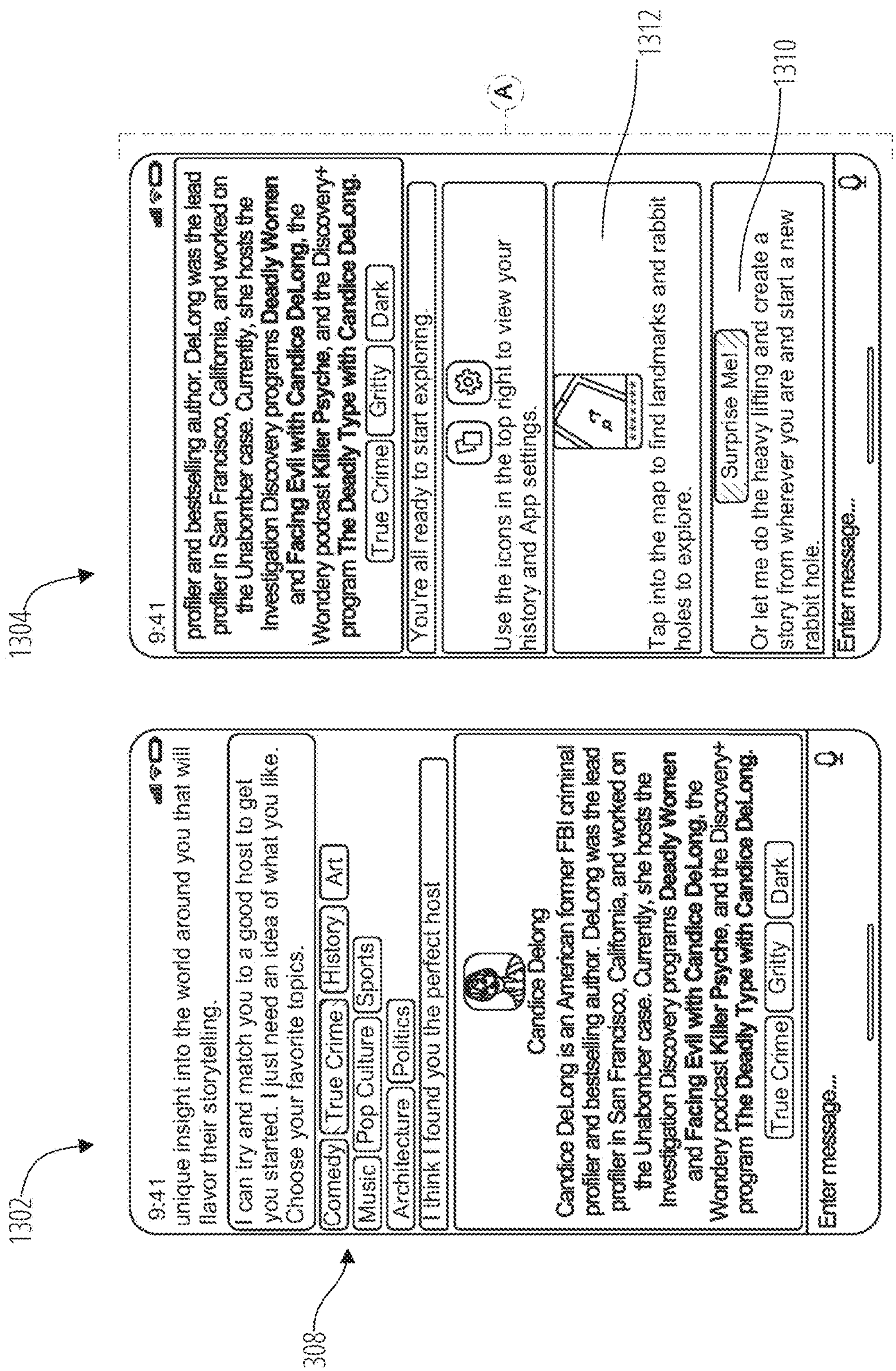

1302
1308
9:41
unique insight into the world around you that will flavor their storytelling.
I can try and match you to a good host to get you started. I just need an idea of what you like. Choose your favorite topics.
Comedy
True Crime
History
Art
Music
Pop Culture
Sports
Architecture
Politics
I think I found you the perfect host
Candice Delong
Candice DeLong is an American former FBI criminal profiler and bestselling author. DeLong was the lead profiler in San Francisco, California, and worked on the Unabomber case. Currently, she hosts the Investigation Discovery programs Deadly Women and Facing Evil with Candice DeLong, the Wondery podcast Killer Psyche, and the Discovery+ program The Deadly Type with Candice DeLong.
True Crime
Gritty
Dark
Enter message...
1304
A
1312
1310
9:41
profiler and bestselling author. DeLong was the lead profiler in San Francisco, California, and worked on the Unabomber case. Currently, she hosts the Investigation Discovery programs Deadly Women and Facing Evil with Candice DeLong, the Wondery podcast Killer Psyche, and the Discovery+ program The Deadly Type with Candice DeLong.
True Crime
Gritty
Dark
You're all ready to start exploring.
Use the icons in the top right to view your history and App settings.
Tap into the map to find landmarks and rabbit holes to explore.
Surprise Me!
Or let me do the heavy lifting and create a story from wherever you are and start a new rabbit hole.
Enter message...

FIG. 13A

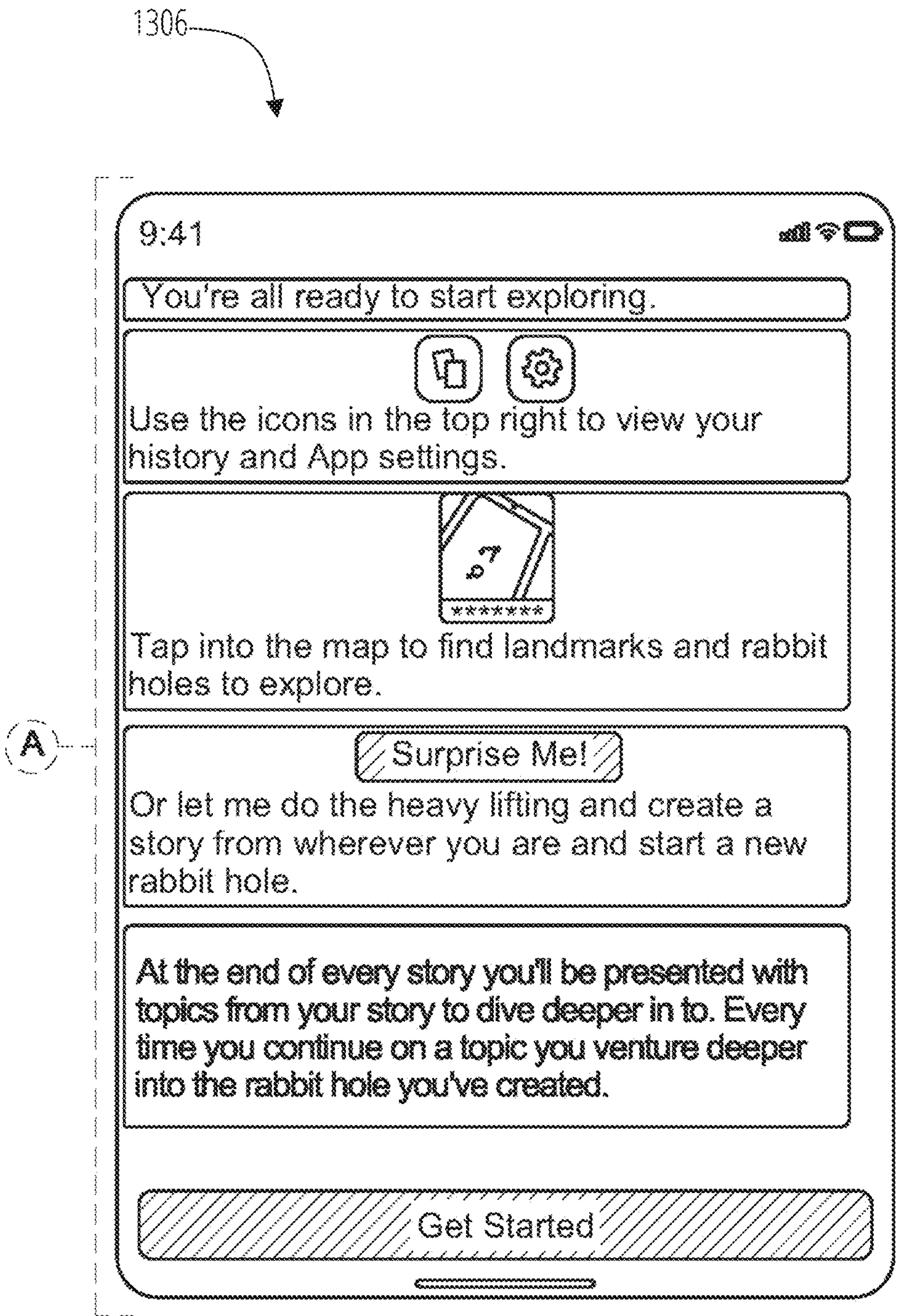

1306
9:41
You're all ready to start exploring.
Use the icons in the top right to view your history and App settings.
Tap into the map to find landmarks and rabbit holes to explore.
A
Surprise Me!
Or let me do the heavy lifting and create a story from wherever you are and start a new rabbit hole.
At the end of every story you'll be presented with topics from your story to dive deeper in to. Every time you continue on a topic you venture deeper into the rabbit hole you've created.
Get Started

FIG. 13B

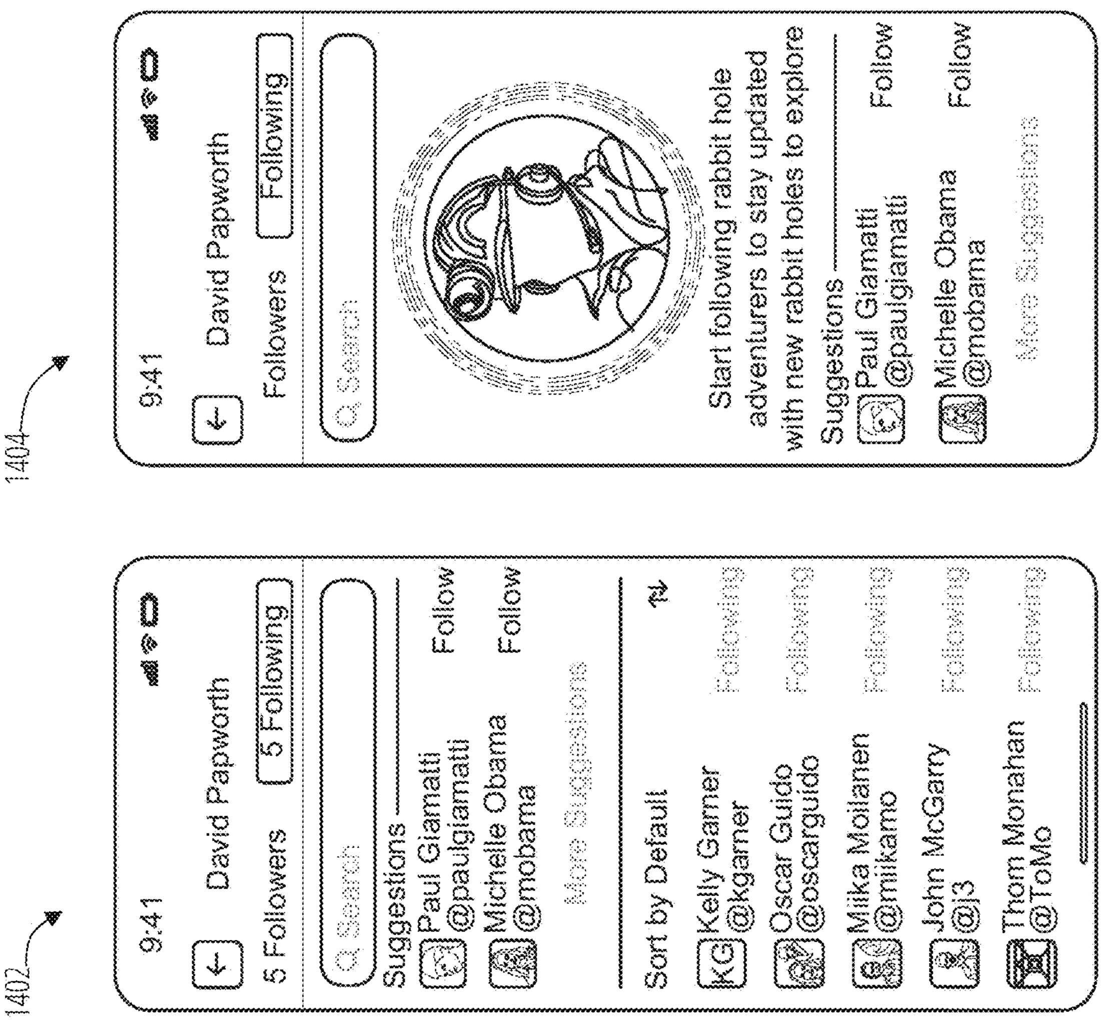
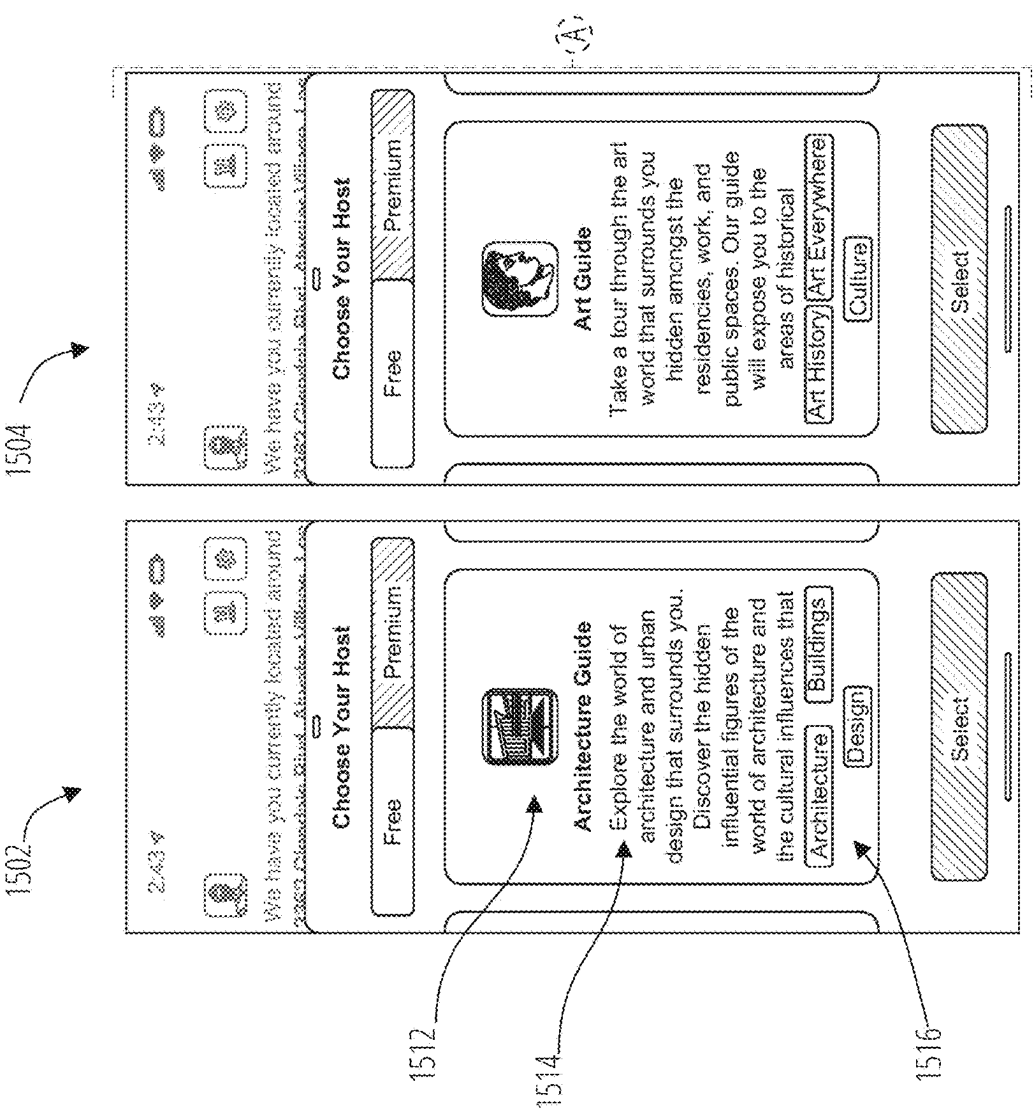

1402
9:41
David Papworth
5 Followers
5 Following
Search
Suggestions
Paul Giamatti
@paulgiamatti
Follow
Michelle Obama
@mobama
Follow
More Suggestions
Sort by Default
Kelly Garner
@kgarner
Following
Oscar Guido
@oscarguido
Following
Mika Moilanen
@mikamo
Following
John McGarry
@j3
Following
Thom Monahan
@ToMo
Following
1404
9:41
David Papworth
Followers
Following
Search
Start following rabbit hole adventures to stay updated with new rabbit holes to explore
Suggestions
Paul Giamatti
@paulgiamatti
Follow
Michelle Obama
@mobama
Follow
More Suggestions

FIG. 14



1502
1504
1512
1514
1516
A
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Architecture Guide
Explore the world of architecture and urban design that surrounds you. Discover the hidden influential figures of the world of architecture and the cultural influences that
Architecture
Buildings
Design
Select
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Art Guide
Take a tour through the art world that surrounds you hidden amongst the residencies, work, and public spaces. Our guide will expose you to the areas of historical
Art History
Art Everywhere
Culture
Select

FIG. 15A

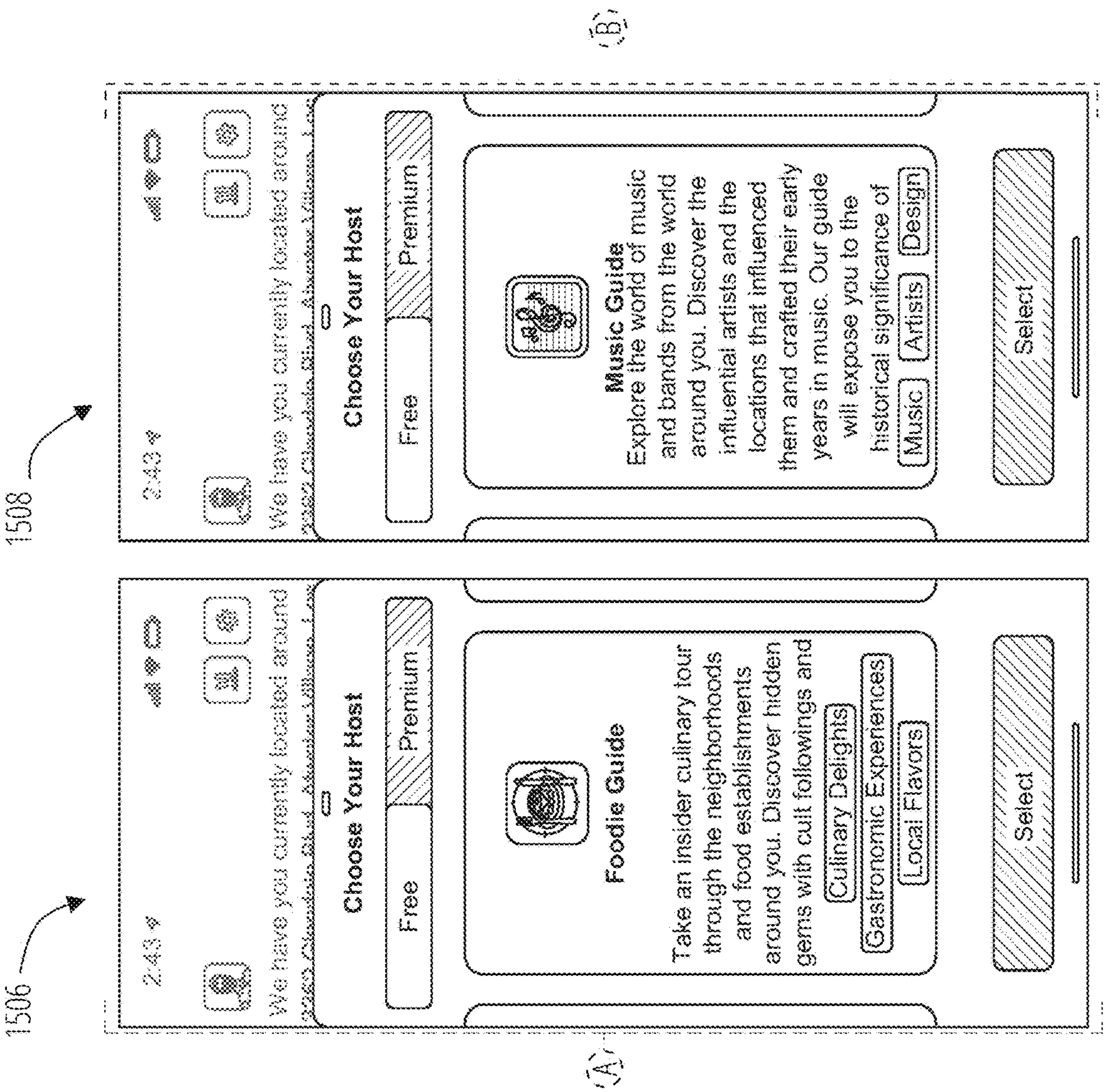

1506
1508
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Foodie Guide
Take an insider culinary tour through the neighborhoods and food establishments around you. Discover hidden gems with cult followings and
Culinary Delights
Gastronomic Experiences
Local Flavors
Select
Music Guide
Explore the world of music and bands from the world around you. Discover the influential artists and the locations that influenced them and crafted their early years in music. Our guide will expose you to the historical significance of
Music
Artists
Design
Select
A
B

FIG. 15B

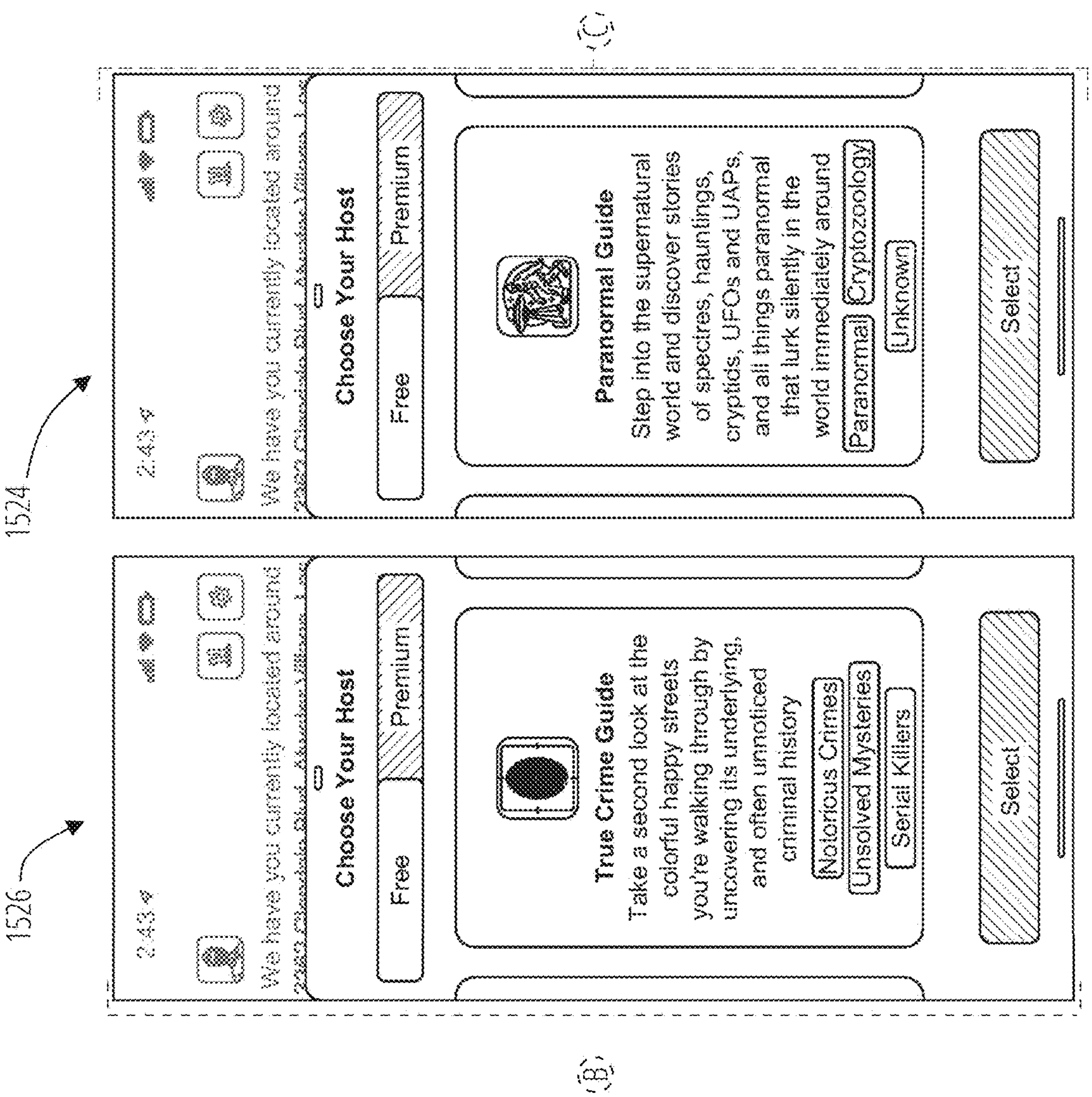

1524
1526
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Paranormal Guide
Step into the supernatural world and discover stories of spectres, hauntings, cryptids, UFOs and UAPs, and all things paranormal that lurk silently in the world immediately around
Paranormal
Cryptozoology
Unknown
Select
True Crime Guide
Take a second look at the colorful happy streets you're walking through by uncovering its underlying, and often unnoticed criminal history
Notorious Crimes
Unsolved Mysteries
Serial Killers
Select
B
C

FIG. 15C

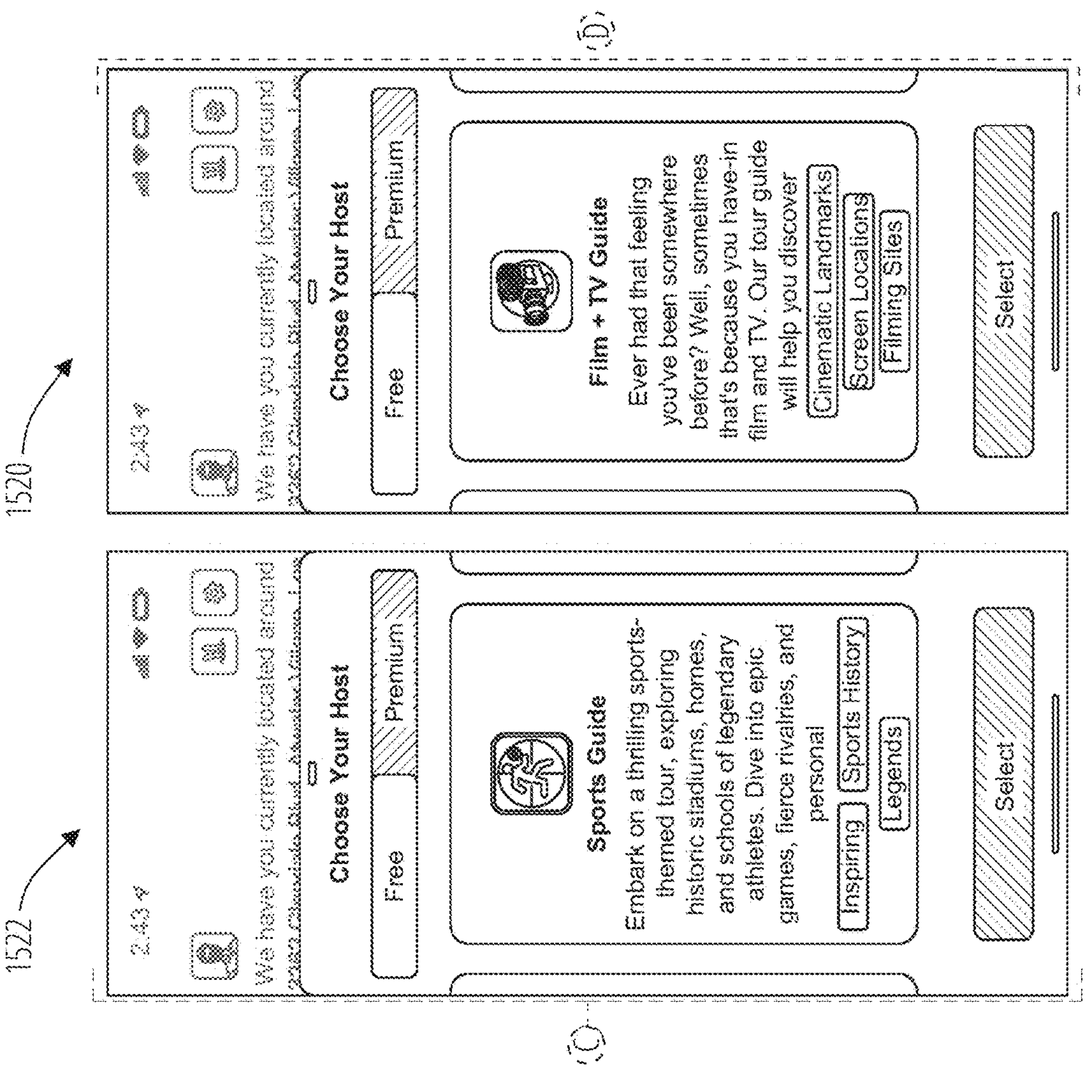

1522
1520
C
D
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Sports Guide
Embark on a thrilling sports-themed tour, exploring historic stadiums, homes, and schools of legendary athletes. Dive into epic games, fierce rivalries, and personal
Inspiring
Sports History
Legends
Select
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Film + TV Guide
Ever had that feeling you've been somewhere before? Well, sometimes that's because you have-in film and TV. Our tour guide will help you discover
Cinematic Landmarks
Screen Locations
Filming Sites
Select

FIG. 15D

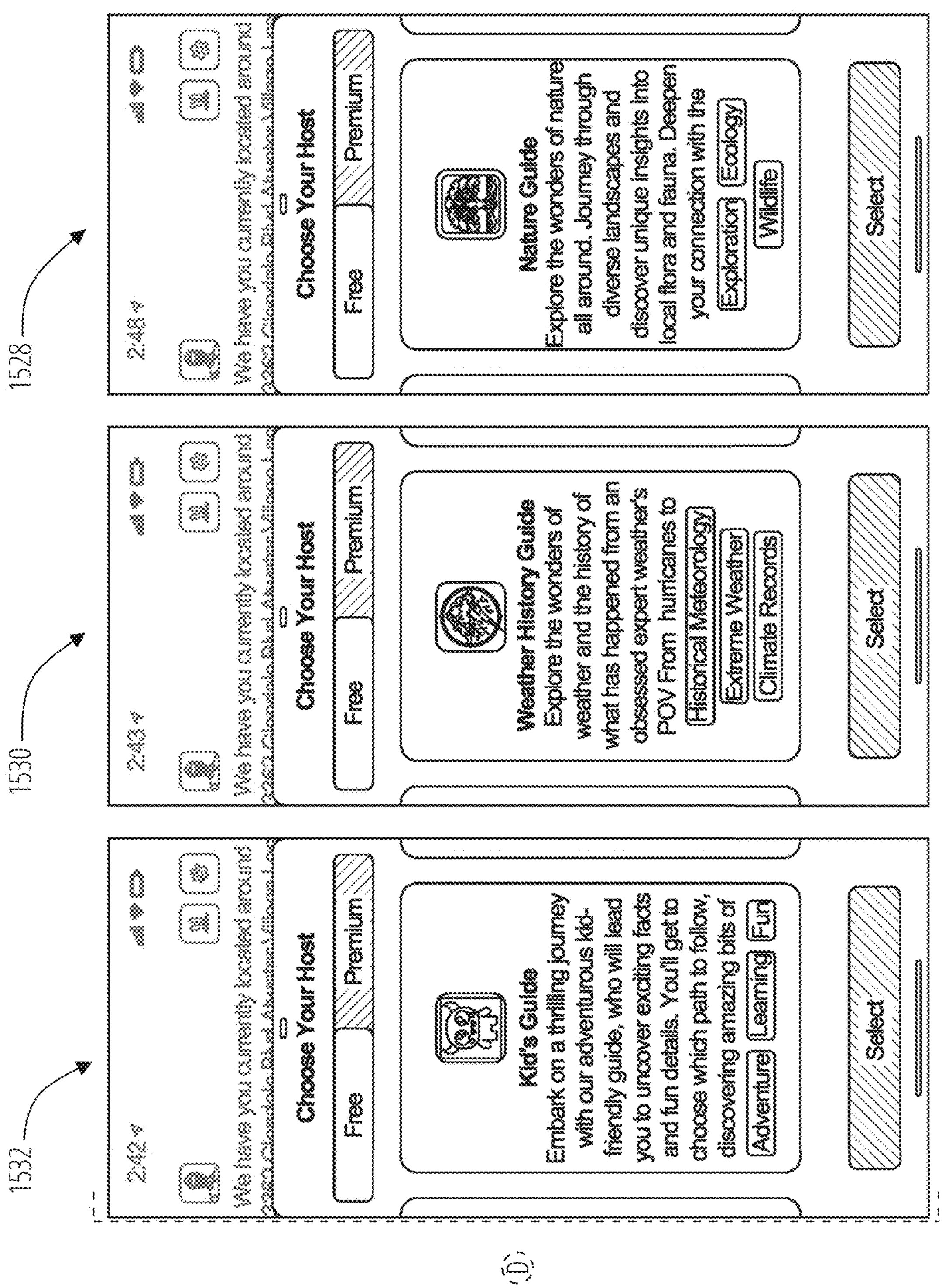

1532
2:42
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Kid's Guide
Embark on a thrilling journey with our adventurous kid-friendly guide, who will lead you to uncover exciting facts and fun details. You'll get to choose which path to follow, discovering amazing bits of
Adventure
Learning
Fun
Select
1530
2:43
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Weather History Guide
Explore the wonders of weather and the history of what has happened from an obsessed expert weather's POV From hurricanes to
Historical Meteorology
Extreme Weather
Climate Records
Select
1528
2:48
We have you currently located around
Choose Your Host
Free
Premium
Nature Guide
Explore the wonders of nature all around. Journey through diverse landscapes and discover unique insights into local flora and fauna. Deepen your connection with the
Exploration
Ecology
Wildlife
Select
D

FIG. 15E

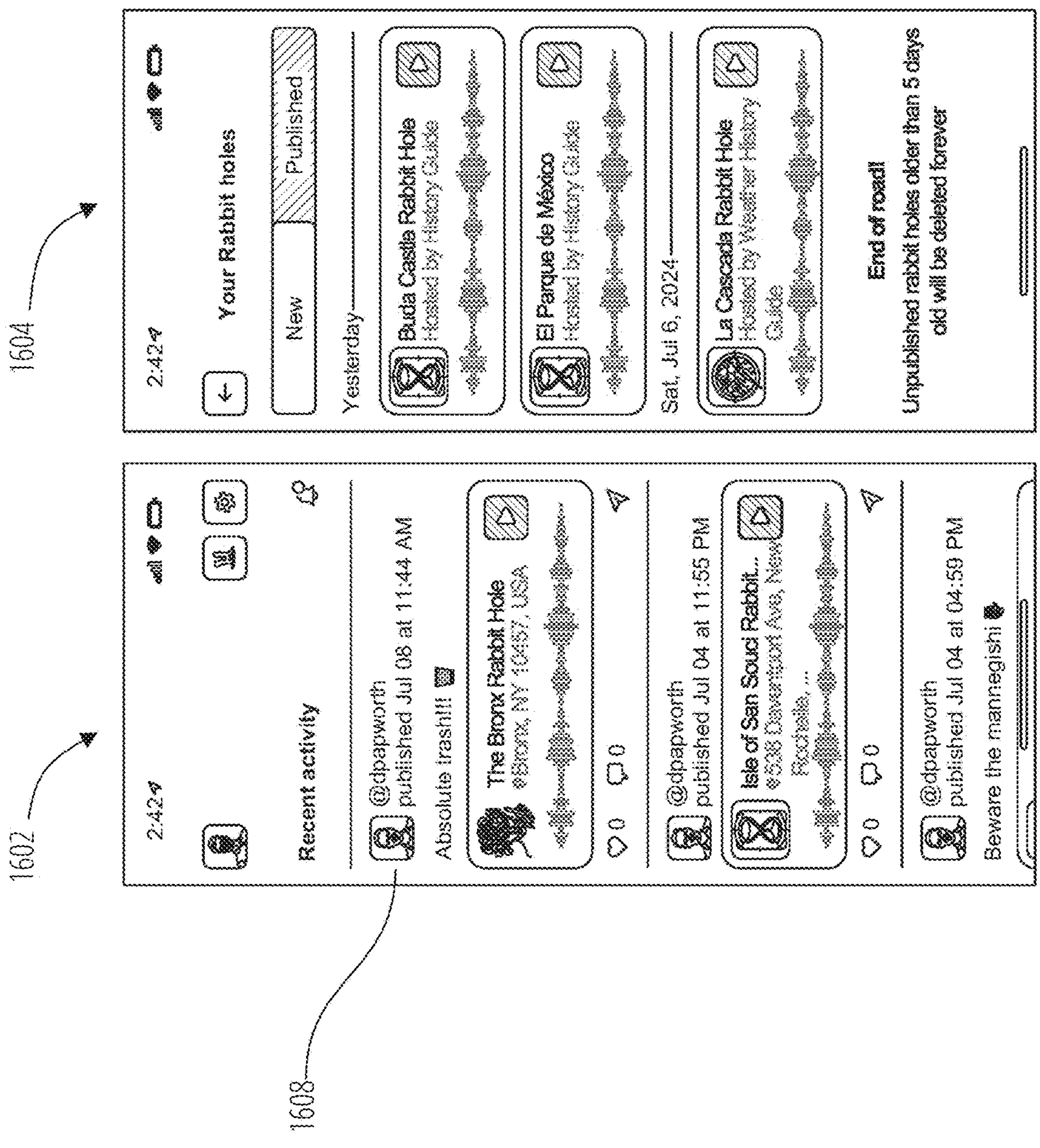

1602
1604
1608
2:42
Recent activity
@dpapworth
published Jul 08 at 11:44 AM
Absolute trash!!!
The Bronx Rabbit Hole
Bronx, NY 10457, USA
0
0
@dpapworth
published Jul 04 at 11:55 PM
Isle of San Souci Rabbit...
538 Davenport Ave, New Rochelle, ...
0
0
@dpapworth
published Jul 04 at 04:59 PM
Beware the mannegishi
2:42
Your Rabbit holes
New
Published
Yesterday
Buda Castle Rabbit Hole
Hosted by History Guide
El Parque de México
Hosted by History Guide
Sat, Jul 6, 2024
La Cascada Rabbit Hole
Hosted by Weather History Guide
End of road!
Unpublished rabbit holes older than 5 days old will be deleted forever

FIG. 16

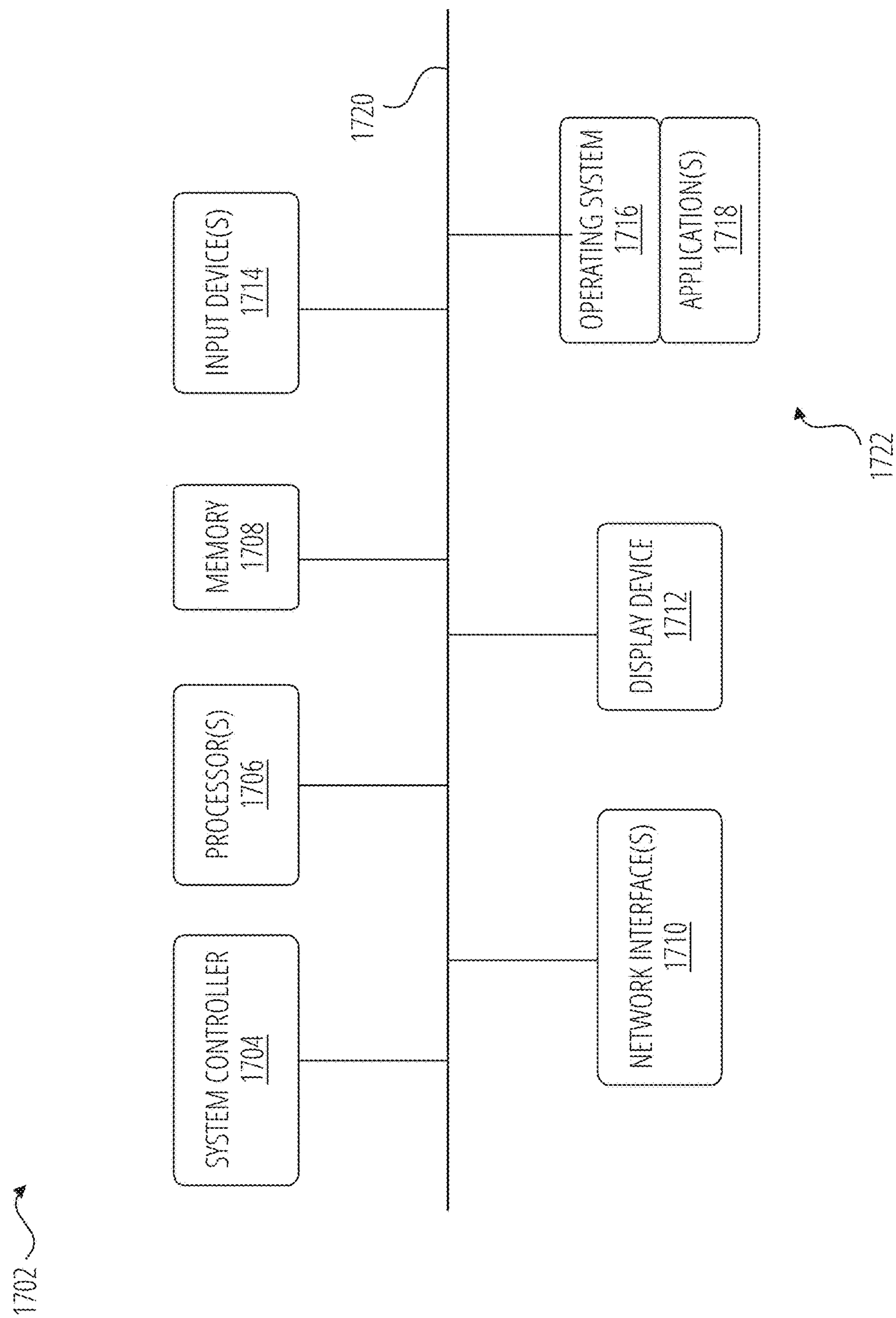

1702
SYSTEM CONTROLLER
1704
PROCESSOR(S)
1706
MEMORY
1708
INPUT DEVICE(S)
1714
1720
NETWORK INTERFACE(S)
1710
DISPLAY DEVICE
1712
OPERATING SYSTEM
1716
APPLICATION(S)
1718
1722

FIG. 17

DYNAMIC AUDIO STORY GENERATION AND SOCIAL NETWORK

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS

[0001] The present application claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/648,061 filed May 15, 2024, and titled "Methods And Systems For Audio Processing And Display On A Social Network" and U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/561,223 filed Mar. 4, 2024, and titled "Methods And Systems For Audio Processing And Display On A Social Network," the disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

[0002] The present disclosure relates to content generation, and more specifically, to generating and presenting customized audio stories and related displays.

BACKGROUND

[0003] Audio tours are useful tools to provide users with information about their surroundings. Often, users will purchase or otherwise obtain an audio tour for a specific location, such as a guided city tour, a museum tour, a nature tour, a zoo tour, and the like. The user can listen along as the audio tour takes them from stop to stop, providing information about whatever is located at the current stop. For example, in a museum tour, the audio tour can provide information about a series of exhibits which the user may access in a predefined order, or on demand (e.g., by keying in an appropriate identifier for a given exhibit).

[0004] Audio tours generally take the form of a set of pre-recorded messages, each of which is associated with a given stop in a set of predetermined stops. While such audio tours may be enjoyable for many, they are limited in scope by the pre-recorded messages and predetermined stops. Further, updating audio tours for any reason can be difficult or outright impossible in many circumstances. For example, if a stop is added, removed, or changed on a city tour, there may be difficulty in finding the original voice actor or a suitable replacement voice actor to provide updated audio content. Further, due to the expenses required to generate new audio tours using traditional means, cost-conscious organizations may be unable to generate useful audio tours and other organizations may be less inclined or able to produce updated or new audio tours. Additionally, whenever an audio tour is desired to be translated into a new language, significant expense and time is required to translate the text and then have a voice actor fluent in that language record the translated text.

[0005] There is a need for improved audio story technology to provide users with informative and/or entertaining audio stories. There is a need for improved audio story technology that encourages users to explore topics and/or locations. There is a need for improved audio story technology that lowers barriers to the creation of new, engaging audio stories. There is a need for improved audio story technology that can quickly provide an audio story in a new language not previously used for that audio story.

BRIEF SUMMARY

[0006] The term embodiment and like terms are intended to refer broadly to all of the subject matter of this disclosure and the claims below. Statements containing these terms should be understood not to limit the subject matter described herein or to limit the meaning or scope of the claims below. Embodiments of the present disclosure covered herein are defined by the claims below, supplemented by this summary. This summary is a high-level overview of various aspects of the disclosure and introduces some of the concepts that are further described in the Detailed Description section below. This summary is not intended to identify key or essential features of the claimed subject matter, nor is it intended to be used in isolation to determine the scope of the claimed subject matter. The subject matter should be understood by reference to appropriate portions of the entire specification of this disclosure, any or all drawings and each claim.

[0007] Embodiments of the present disclosure include a computer-implemented method, which includes receiving location information associated with a user, identifying one or more points of interest (POIs) based at least in part on the location information, dynamically generating story content based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs, and providing the story content for presentation to the user.

[0008] In some cases, dynamically generating the story content includes generating a story transcript based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs, and generating story audio content based at least in part on the story transcript. In some cases, receiving the location information includes receiving global positioning satellite (GPS) coordinates associated with a user device of the user, and determining the location information based at least in part on the GPS coordinates. In some cases, identifying the one or more POIs includes receiving a user POI selection indicative of at least one POI of the one or more POIs. The computer-implemented method may also include receiving one or more camera images associated with a user device of the user, where identifying the one or more POIs is based at least in part on the one or more camera images. The computer-implemented method may also include storing the dynamically generated story content for later use. In some cases, providing the story content for presentation to the user includes providing one or more follow-up prompts for presentation to the user following presentation of the story content.

[0009] The computer-implemented method may also include receiving a story host selection, where generating the story transcript is further based at least in part on the story host selection, and where generating the story audio content is further based at least in part on the story host selection. In some cases, the story host selection is indicative of a story theme and a voice identifier, where generating the story transcript includes preparing a custom prompt based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs and the story theme, passing the custom prompt to a large language model (LLM) generative artificial intelligence (AI), and receiving an AI response from the LLM generative AI, the story transcript being based at least in part on the AI response; and where generating the story audio content includes passing the voice identifier and the story transcript to an artificial intelligence (AI) audio synthesis engine and receiving synthesized audio in response to passing the voice identifier and the story transcript, the story audio content being based at least in part on the synthesized audio.

[0010] In some cases, generating the story transcript includes preparing a custom prompt based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs, passing the custom prompt to a large language model (LLM) generative artificial intelligence (AI), and receiving an AI response from the LLM generative AI, the story transcript being based at least in part on the AI response. In some cases, preparing the custom prompt is further based at least in part on one or more preferences associated with the user. In some cases, preparing the custom prompt includes selecting a prompt template from a plurality of prompt templates, and the custom prompt is based at least in part on the selected prompt template. In some cases, the location information includes a location name, and preparing the custom prompt is further based at least in part on the location name.

[0011] The computer-implemented method may also include identifying one or more advertisement vendors associated with the location information or the one or more POIs, where preparing the custom prompt is based at least in part on the one or more advertisement vendors such that the AI response includes content associated with the one or more advertisement vendors. The computer-implemented method may also include identifying one or more advertisements associated with the location information or the one or more POIs, where generating the story transcript includes combining the one or more advertisements with at least a portion of the AI response to create the story transcript.

[0012] In some cases, generating the story audio content includes receiving a voice identifier, passing the voice identifier and the story transcript to an artificial intelligence (AI) audio synthesis engine, and receiving synthesized audio in response to passing the voice identifier and the story transcript, the story audio content being based at least in part on the synthesized audio. The computer-implemented method may also include identifying one or more audio advertisements associated with the location information or the one or more POIs, where generating the story audio content includes combining the one or more audio advertisements with at least a portion of the synthesized audio to create the story audio content.

[0013] The computer-implemented method may also include generating a shareable uniform resource locator (URL) associated with the stored story content, where the URL, when accessed by an additional user, causes the stored story content to be provided to the additional user.

[0014] Embodiments of the present disclosure include a system includes a control system including one or more processors, and a memory having stored thereon machine readable instructions, where the control system is coupled to the memory, and any of the methods disclosed above is implemented when the machine executable instructions in the memory are executed by at least one of the one or more processors of the control system.

[0015] Embodiments of the present disclosure include a computer program product embodied on a non-transitory computer-readable medium and includes instructions which, when executed by a computer, cause the computer to carry out any of the methods disclosed above.

[0016] Other technical features may be readily apparent to one skilled in the art from the following figures, descriptions, and claims.

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

[0017] To easily identify the discussion of any particular element or act, the most significant digit or digits in a reference number refer to the figure number in which that element is first introduced.

[0018] FIG. **1** is a block diagram depicting a story generation and sharing ecosystem, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0019] FIG. **2** is a flowchart depicting a process for dynamically generating story content, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0020] FIG. **3** is a flowchart depicting a process for dynamically generating a story transcript, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0021] FIG. **4** is a flowchart depicting a process for dynamically generating story audio content, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0022] FIG. **5** is a flowchart depicting a process for encouraging follow-up interactions, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0023] FIG. **6** is a chart depicting a story content generation workflow, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0024] FIG. **7** is a chart depicting a follow-up content generation workflow, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0025] FIG. **8** is a chart depicting a social interaction workflow and a story management workflow, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0026] FIG. **9** is a set of screenshots depicting graphical user interfaces (GUIs) for general startup and POI selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0027] FIG. **10** is a screenshot depicting an alternate GUI for POI selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0028] FIG. **11** is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for story playback, activity information, and user preferences, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0029] FIG. **12**A is a portion of a diagram depicting available story hosts, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0030] FIG. **12**B is a continuation portion of the diagram of FIG. **12**A.

[0031] FIG. **12**C is a continuation portion of the diagram of FIG. **12**B.

[0032] FIG. **13**A is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for host selection and initial POI selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0033] FIG. **13**B is a continuation of the screenshots of FIG. **13**A.

[0034] FIG. **14** is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for social interactions, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0035] FIG. **15**A, is a portion of a diagram depicting GUI screens for story host selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0036] FIG. **15**B is a continuation portion of the diagram of FIG. **15**A.

[0037] FIG. **15**C is a continuation portion of the diagram of FIG. **15**B.

[0038] FIG. **15**D is a continuation portion of the diagram of FIG. **15**C.

[0039] FIG. **15**E is a continuation portion of the diagram of FIG. **15**D.

[0040] FIG. 16 is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for social interaction, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0041] FIG. 17 is a block diagram of an example system architecture for implementing features and processes of the present disclosure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

[0042] Certain aspects and features of the present disclosure relate to creating highly personalized stories, such as audio stories. A system can receive location information associated with a user, such as from a user device (e.g., a mobile phone or tablet). The location information can be used to help identify one or more points of interest (POIs). In some cases, user input can be used to select a particular POI, or a POI can be automatically selected by the system through a "surprise me" function. In some cases, a user can select or the system can auto-select a host, which can represent a personality (e.g., a true crime podcaster, a documentarian, a comedian, an art historian, and the like). The POI and host information can be used to generate a custom prompt that can be fed into a large language model (LLM) generative AI to generate an output used to create a story transcript. The story transcript and host information can then be fed into an audio synthesis engine to generate synthesized audio used to create story audio content. The story audio content and optionally the story transcript can then be presented to the user. After completion of the story, the user can be presented with one or more follow-up prompts based on the POI used to generate the story or the story transcript itself (e.g., based on POIs mentioned in the story).

[0043] As used herein, the term story is intended to include short or long narrations in text form, non-text visual form (e.g., icons and rebuses), and/or audio form. Generally, however, the term story will take the form of a short narration in audio form, often accompanied by a transcript in text form. Stories can be fictional (e.g., imaginative tales) or non-fictional (e.g., news articles, architectural descriptions, sports facts, etc.).

[0044] Each story can be associated with a particular location or POI. A POI can be any suitable point of interest, such as buildings, businesses, intersections, natural features, human-made features, neighborhoods, regions, cities, states, countries, and the like. As used herein, the term location is intended to refer to a particular geolocation, which can be associated with (e.g., can include) a single POI or multiple POIs. In some cases, the term POI can be inclusive of an individual associated with a particular location. For example, when nearby the birthplace of Edgard Allen Poe, "Edgard Allen Poe" may be considered a POI and may be selectable for story generation.

[0045] A collection of stories can be referred to as a tour. A user may engage the tour by going to the various locations associated with the stories in the tour and listening to or reading the appropriate story for each location. For example, a tour may be created for a museum by identifying multiple POIs within the museum and generating stories, as disclosed in further detail herein, for each of those POIs.

[0046] Location information can include a geolocation (e.g., GPS coordinates) and optionally a location name or other identifying information. In some cases, when GPS coordinates are known, the system can access an appropriate application programming interface (API) or other resource to determine the location name from the GPS coordinates.

[0047] The location information can be used to determine one or more POIs associated with that location, such as via geolocation or via location name. In some cases, multiple potential POIs can be identified, such as all POIs within a threshold distance of the user's current geolocation or identified as being located at the location name. In some cases, at least some of the potential POIs can be displayed to a user to give the user an option to select one of the potential POIs for subsequent story generation. In some cases, a user may elect to use an auto-select feature (e.g., a "surprise me" feature) that will automatically select, from the potential POIs, a POI for subsequent story generation. The auto-select feature can be random, pseudo-random, or non-random. In some cases, the auto-select feature can select a POI based on certain criteria, such as the POI nearest the user's geolocation, the POI previously identified by the user as being of interest (e.g., saved to a wish list), the POI most frequented by other users, the POI having a highest rating or score (e.g., a real-world rating of the POI itself, such as a restaurant rating, or a rating of stories generated from the POI, such as user-provided ratings after listening to a story generated from that POI).

[0048] Once a POI is selected, it can be used to generate a custom prompt that can be passed to an LLM generative AI to output an AI response that is usable to create the story transcript. In some cases, the AI response itself is used as the story transcript, although that need not always be the case. For example, advertisements or other information may be combined with the AI response to create the final story transcript. The custom prompt can be based on the POI and optionally additional factors, such as a host selection and/or user preferences.

[0049] As used herein, the term host is intended to refer to a persona used to define certain parameters for story generation. Hosts can be entirely fictional, can be based on a real-life persona (e.g., a fictional persona designed to have some similar traits of a human individual), and/or can be representative of a human individual (e.g., a host that is based on a celebrity's persona and uses a voice synthesizer trained using that celebrity's voice). Each host can define multiple parameters, such as a genre (e.g., news, comedy, society & culture, business, true crime, sports, religion and spirituality, arts, government, etc.) and a voice identifier. In some cases, available hosts can be provided in a list. In some cases, users (e.g., all users or users with specific permissions) can create their own hosts, such as by providing their own genre label, their own custom prompt template information (e.g., a prompt template or information for using/modifying an existing prompt template), and/or their own voice identifier.

[0050] The genre of a selected host can be used in the creation of the custom prompt. For example, when a true crime host is selected, the custom prompt may be something like "describe, like a true crime podcaster, information about any crimes that have been committed at or within the vicinity of <the POI>, or otherwise relating to <the POI>," where <the POI> is intended to be replaced by the name of the selected POI. However, when a food critic host is selected, the custom prompt may be something like "write a 150-200 word review of the restaurant at <the POI> including information about the quality and selection of their food, an average price per meal, and bathroom accommodations."

[0051] A custom prompt can be generated by leveraging the POI (e.g., an official or common name of the POI), the host selection (e.g., a genre and/or persona associated with the selected host), and other optional information (e.g., user preferences, such as preference for shorter or longer stories or preference for less complex vocabulary). Generating the custom prompt can include selecting a prompt template for use (e.g., selected based on information about the POI, such as whether the POI is a city, a building, or a business; on information about the host, such as a genre and/or personality associated with the host; and optionally on other information, such as user preferences. In some cases, each host is associated with a particular prompt template.

[0052] Once a story transcript is generated, it can be provided to an audio synthesis engine to generate audio based on the story transcript. The audio synthesis engine can take text as input and output audio content, such as music, sound effects, or voice content. Generally, the audio synthesis engine can be designed to output only voice content, although that need not always be the case. The audio synthesis engine can be embodied across one or more systems and/or one or more APIs. In some cases, the text provided as input to the audio synthesis engine can be used to define the style of voice used for voice content. In some cases, however, a specific vocal identifier can be passed to the audio synthesis engine to have the audio synthesis engine generate the voice content in the appropriate voice. In such an example, the audio synthesis engine may make use of many different audio synthesis models, each one associated with a particular voice identifier. Voice identifiers can be in any form or format, such as identification numbers, alphanumeric strings, voice names, and the like. For example, a selected host may be associated with a voice identifier "Fred" in which case passing the story transcript and the voice identifier to the audio synthesis engine would result in an output audio file of the "Fred" voice reading the story transcript. In some cases, language information is passed to the audio synthesis engine to ensure the output is in the proper language.

[0053] Language information can be passed in the form of a unique preference (e.g., an indication for English, Spanish, French, etc.). In some cases, however, the language information is inherent in the voice identifier, as the voice associated with the voice identifier may itself be inherently associated with a particular language (e.g., "Fred" may be associated with English, "Federico" may be associated with Spanish, and "Frédéric" may be associated with French). As used herein, the term language with reference to synthesizing audio is intended to include (i) differentiating between languages (e.g., English, Spanish, French); and/or (ii) differentiating between subsets or dialects of languages (e.g., English—American, English—British, Spanish—Peninsular, Spanish—Americas).

[0054] The output of the audio synthesis engine can be referred to as synthesized audio. In some cases, the synthesized audio itself is used as the story audio content, although that need not always be the case. For example, audio advertisements or other audio content may be combined with the synthesized audio to create the final story audio content.

[0055] The story audio content and/or the story transcript can be provided for presentation to the user, such as via a mobile app. In some cases, the story audio content and/or the story transcript, optionally along with any inputs used to generate the story audio content and/or the story transcript, can be stored for later use.

[0056] In some cases, the user can select a host prior to selecting a POI and the system can automatically generate a list of relevant POIs from the list of all available POIs. For example, when selecting a host associated with arts, the system may identify, from the list of all available POIs, those POIs that are likely to be related to arts, such as museums, buildings with murals, and the like.

[0057] In some cases, a user can provide feedback for a story, such as to identify one or more ratings (e.g., overall enjoyment rating, story quality rating, voice quality rating, etc.), to identify one or more factual inaccuracies (e.g., hallucinations from the LLM generative AI), to provide additional information (e.g., photographs of the POI), and/or the like.

[0058] In some cases, story generation can occur for multiple POIs In some cases, story generation for multiple POIs can take the form of sequential story generation, in which case unique stories are generated for each POI. In some cases, however, story generation for multiple POIs can take the form of combination story generation, in which case a story can be generated that is based on multiple POIs. In an example, a user may select three buildings along a street as desired POIs. In such an example, sequential story generation would involve performing story generation for each POI individually (e.g., by creating custom prompts for each POI), resulting in three separate stories. However, if combination story generation were used, the three POIs can be used in combination to generate a single prompt which can be fed to an LLM generative AI to ultimately create a single story transcript. Such a combination story transcript might discuss a topic common to the three POIs and/or may discuss and/or compare information about the three POIs. For example, an architectural-style story generated on three buildings may compare and contrast the different architectural features of the three buildings with one another.

[0059] Certain aspects and features of the present disclosure are especially useful for improving the fields of story generation and tour generation, at least by allowing for on-demand generation of new story transcripts and new story audio content for POIs. Further, certain aspects and features of the present disclosure facilitate the creation of new, location-based, creative content (e.g., story transcripts and story audio content), which can be presented to a user and/or further leveraged for other purposes. Additionally, the use of follow-up prompts based on the POI or story transcript from a prior story enable a new way to engage with one's surroundings, such as by selecting an initial nearby POI and then going down "rabbit holes" of recursive, related POIs.

[0060] These illustrative examples are given to introduce the reader to the general subject matter discussed here and are not intended to limit the scope of the disclosed concepts. The following sections describe various additional features and examples with reference to the drawings in which like numerals indicate like elements, and directional descriptions are used to describe the illustrative embodiments but, like the illustrative embodiments, should not be used to limit the present disclosure. The elements included in the illustrations herein may not be drawn to scale.

[0061] FIG. **1** is a block diagram depicting a story generation and sharing system **100**, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The story generation and sharing system **100** includes a user interface **102** (e.g., a frontend) and a back end **104**. The user interface **102** and/or the back end **104** communicates with external services **106** to perform various functions. The external services **106** can be considered to form part of the story generation and sharing system **100** (e.g., when the external services **106** are implemented together along with the back end **104**) or to be separate from the story generation and sharing system **100** (e.g., when a first organization implements the back end **104** and third-party organizations implement the external services **106**).

[0062] The story generation and sharing system **100** can be implemented on one or more computing devices (e.g., personal computers, smartphones, tablets, servers, etc.) located in one or more locations. Generally, the user interface **102** will operate on (e.g., be presented on and receive user input from) a user device (e.g., a smartphone, tablet, personal computer). Often, the user device will be a mobile device that permits the user to easily engage the user interface **102** at various locations.

[0063] The mobile app **108** is an application (e.g., a native application or web application) that interfaces with the back end **104** and/or the external services **106** to perform various functions. The mobile app **108** receives user input, such as in the form of tapping on buttons or icons, entering text, acquiring camera images, or the like; and provides output to the user, such as in the form of a graphical user interface or audio playback.

[0064] In some cases, the user interface **102** can include a website **110** accessible from a user device. The website **110** can perform some or all of the functions of the mobile app **108**, or different functions. For example, the website **110** can provide an interface designed more to allow users to identify POIs via manual searching while the mobile app **108** can provide an interface designed more to allow users to identify POIs via one or more sensors of the user device (e.g., a GPS receiver to acquire GPS coordinates, a camera to obtain photographs of a POI).

[0065] In some cases, the user interface **102** can handle initiating requests to the back end **104**, such as requests to generate a story, and receiving responses to such requests, such as to start playback of a generated story. In some cases, the user interface **102** can handle initiating requests to external services **106** and receiving responses to such requests, such as to identify a location name from GPS coordinates via a geolocation API **118** (e.g., the Google® Places API).

[0066] The back end **104** can be responsible for handling exchanges with the user interface **102** and various external services **106**, as well as handling other logic. The back end **104** can include a database **112**, a business logic **114** component, and an AI logic **116** component. The database **112** can store various types of information, such as information about hosts, information about users, information about POIs, previously generated stories, and the like. The database **112** can include a collection of prompt templates.

[0067] The business logic **114** component can receive a story generation request from the user interface **102** and can process the request to determine what information from the database **112** is to be used (e.g., what prompt template to use, what host to use, etc.). The business logic **114** can then pass the information to the AI logic **116** component, which can compile the custom prompt (e.g., using the prompt template and optionally information associated with the host, such as a genre). The AI logic **116** can then send the custom prompt to one or more of the external services **106**, such as to the LLM generative AI API **122** (e.g., OpenAI™ API, AWS® Bedrock® API, etc.). The LLM generative AI API **122** can generate an AI response that is sent back to the AI logic **116**. The AI logic **116** can then use that AI response as a story transcript or to generate a story transcript. The AI logic **116** can send the story transcript to another of the external services **106**, such as to the audio synthesis API **120** (e.g., ElvenLabs™ API). As used herein, the audio synthesis API **120** can be referred to as an audio synthesis engine. The audio synthesis API **120** can use the story transcript to generate synthesized audio (e.g., synthesized speech) which can be provided back to the AI logic **116**. The AI logic **116** can use the synthesized audio as story audio content itself or to generate story audio content. The AI logic **116** can provide the story audio content and/or the story transcript to the business logic **114**, which can then communicate the story audio content and/or the story transcript to the user interface **102** for presentation to a user.

[0068] While described as separate APIs as part of external services **106**, in some cases some of the functions of the external services **106** can be implemented as part of the back end **104** itself. While described with certain components, in some cases, a story generation and sharing system **100** can include fewer components, addition components, and/or different components. In some cases, the user interface **102**, the back end **104**, and each of the external services **106** can be implemented using their own computing environments, although that need not always be the case.

[0069] FIG. **2** is a flowchart depicting a process **200** for dynamically generating story content, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. Various blocks of process **200** can occur in realtime or near realtime, allowing for realtime or near realtime generation of story content.

[0070] At block **202**, location information is received. Location information can include raw location information (e.g., GPS coordinates) or processed location information (e.g., a location name). In some cases, determining location information at block **202** can include determining a location name at block **212**. A location name can be a colloquial or easily readable identifier for a location, such as a business name or a street address. In some cases, determining a location name at block **212** can include using GPS coordinates (e.g., as obtained from a GPS sensor (e.g., GPS receiver) of a mobile device) to determine the location name. In such cases, the GPS coordinates can be supplied to a geolocation API (e.g., geolocation API **118** of FIG. **1**), which can identify that location(s) are associated with those GPS coordinates. In some cases, determining a location name at block **212** can include using other sensor data, such as one or more digital camera images, to identify a location name. In such cases, the digital camera images can be provided to an appropriate API capable of returning a location name based on one or more digital images (e.g., an image classifier API).

[0071] At block **204**, one or more POIs can be identified. Location information from block **202** can be used to identify one or more POIs or a set of available POIs. The available POIs can be presented to a user for selection. In some cases, the available POIs can be filtered based on preset or user-set options (e.g., only show the top 5 results within 0.5 miles of the user).

[0072] Identifying a POI at block **204** can include receiving a user POI selection at block **214** indicating a particular POI or set of POIs to use. For example, when presented with a list of available POIs or a map with icons representing available POIs, the user may tap on the desired POI(s) to make a selection. In some other cases, identifying one or more POIs can be performed automatically at block **216** by auto-selecting POIs. For example, a user can tap a "surprise me" button after which the system can select (e.g., randomly, pseudo-randomly, or non-randomly) one or more POI(s) from the available POIs.

[0073] At block **206**, story content can be dynamically generated. Dynamically generating story content can include generating a story transcript at block **218** and/or generating story audio content at block **220**. The story content can be generating using the identified POI(s) from block **204**, and optionally additional information (e.g., location information from block **202**, host information, user preferences, etc.). At block **218**, a custom prompt can be generated using at least the identified POI(s) from block **204** and optionally other information (e.g., host information). The custom prompt can be provided to an LLM generative AI, which can then output an AI response. The AI response can be used as the story transcript or can be used to generate the story transcript (e.g., by inserting content at the beginning of, at the end of, or within the AI response). For example, in some cases the AI response can be combined with advertising content associated with the POI(s) used to generate the AI response. In some cases, such advertising content can be selected as being directly associated with a POI (e.g., an advertisement that is advertising services provided by the POI), being nearby the POI (e.g., an advertisement for a business located within walking distance of the POI), being associated with a topic that is related to the POI (e.g., an advertisement for an art supply store when visiting a POI that is an art gallery, or an advertisement for an online authorized reseller of sports clothing when the POI is a professional sports venue), or the like.

[0074] At block **220**, the story transcript from block **218** can be provided to an audio synthesis engine to generate synthesized audio. The audio synthesis engine can be a voice synthesizer capable of generating realistic, human-sounding synthetic voices in multiple voices, optionally across multiple languages. The voice synthesizer can make use of many different text-to-speech AI models to provide different voices. In some cases, a voice may be entirely synthesized without association to a single individual. In some cases, however, a voice can be a cloned voice intended to clone the speech of an individual, such as a celebrity. In some cases, an audio synthesis engine can include synthesizers capable of generating non-voice audio content, such as sound effects and music. For example, generating the story audio content at block **220** may include initially generating synthesized speech using the story transcript, then generating synthesized music and/or sound effects using the synthesized speech and/or story transcript as input, all of which can be combined to generate synthesized audio that contains the synthesized speech in addition to synthesized music and/or sound effects. In an example of generating synthesized audio for a true-crime-podcast-style story, the synthesized audio may have intro and outro music, audio narration, and musical stings at especially intense parts of the story. The synthesized audio can be used as the story audio content itself, or can be used to generate the story audio content (e.g., by inserting content at the beginning of, at the end of, or within the synthesized audio). For example, in some cases the synthesized audio can be combined with audio advertisements (e.g., pre-recorded advertising audio content or separately synthesized advertising audio content) associated with the POI(s) used to generate the story transcript. Audio advertisements can be selected similarly to or the same as how advertisements are selected as described above with reference to generating a story transcript at block **218**.

[0075] Then, the story transcript from block **218** and/or the story audio content from block **220** can be provided as story content at block **208**. Providing the story content can include transmitting the story transcript and/or story audio content to a user interface (e.g., user interface **102** of FIG. **1**) running on a user device.

[0076] In some cases, the story content at be stored for future use at block **210**. In some cases, storing the story content can include storing any of the information used to generate the story content, such as location information from block **202**, POI(s) from block **204**, and/or other information (e.g., host information, user information, etc.). The stored story content can be associated with a shareable URL, thus allowing a user to share the generated story content with other users. In some cases, the stored story content can be re-used or made available when other users attempt to generate a story with the same inputs (e.g., the same POI(s) and the same host), although that need not always be the case.

[0077] While process **200** is described with reference to various blocks in a particular order, in some cases process **200** can include additional blocks, fewer blocks, and/or different blocks, in the same or different orders. For example, in some cases, process **200** may include an additional block between block **202** and block **206** for receiving a host selection from the user. In some cases, some blocks can be merged together or split into additional blocks.

[0078] FIG. **3** is a flowchart depicting a process **300** for dynamically generating a story transcript, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. Process **300** can be performed on any suitable computing device or set of computing devices, such as a backend server.

[0079] At block **302**, a selection of POIs are received. In some cases, the selection of POIs can include a single POI, although in other cases multiple POIs can be received at once. Receiving a POI can include receiving a POI name, a POI location or address, a POI description, or any other suitable a POI identifier (e.g., an identification number or a link to a website associated with the POI). Often, receiving the POI includes receiving a POI name, such as a common name used to refer to the POI (e.g., for a business, the doing-business-as name; for an intersection, a colloquial name for the intersection or the names of the intersecting streets; for a building, the address or the building name).

[0080] At block **304**, user preferences are received. Any suitable user preferences can be used to tailor the generation of the story. A user preference can be any suitable preference used to affect generation of the custom prompt. For example, a user preference for a particular language may affect how a custom prompt is generated at block **312** such that the custom prompt leads to a response in the preferred language (e.g., by including in the prompt a request for the response to be in that language, or by translating the entire prompt into that language prior to passing it to the LLM generative AI). As another example, a user preference may be indicative of one or more preferred genres (e.g., true crime, documentary, comedy, etc.). Such a genre preference may be used to narrow down appropriate POIs as part of or prior to block **302** (e.g., only show to the user POIs that would be applicable to the user's preferred genre(s)) and/or narrow down appropriate hosts as part of or prior to block **306** (e.g., only show hosts or auto-select from hosts that fit with the user's preferred genre(s)). However, in some cases, the genre preference can be used to alter generation of the custom prompt separately from how a POI and/or a host is used in the generation of a custom prompt. In such an example, a documentary host may be selected for generation of a documentary story on a selected POI, but user preferences may indicate one or more additional preferred genres (e.g., comedy and architecture), in which case the custom prompt that is generated can primarily emphasize the documentary genre, but also mention the additional preferred genre(s) (e.g., "Prepare a script for a documentary about the Washington Monument with extra focus on its architecture, in a comedic tone").

[0081] At block **306**, a host selection is received. Receiving the host selection can include receiving information identifying a host to use, which can include a host name, a host identifier (e.g., a number or an alphanumeric identifier), a host description (e.g., "a host with a calm and friendly female voice who focuses primarily on architectural features of buildings"), or the like. The host selection can be used to inform custom prompt generation. Each host can be associated with certain host information defining how the host affects generation of a story, including creation of the custom prompt and/or generation of synthesized audio. In some cases, this host information can include one or more genres (e.g., host "Candice" may be associated with a true crime genre, while host "Stephen" may be associated with monsterology and cryptozoology genres). The genre can be used to inform custom prompt generation such that the proper script is created based on that host's genre(s).

[0082] In some cases, host information can be used to indicate a particular style of presentation, which can affect generation of the story transcript and/or generation of the story audio content. A style of presentation can include any primarily non-substantive attributes of a story, such as the general tone of the story, the types of words used, the cadence of the story, and the like. Examples of different styles include academic, salesy, compassionate, strict, free-form, motivational, training, friendly, distant, flat, and the like.

[0083] In some cases, host information can include a voice identifier indicative of a particular voice to use when generating the synthesized audio. The voice identifier can be any suitable identifier, such as a voice name, an identification number or alphanumeric code, a voice description (e.g., a deep gravelly voice), or the like. The voice identifier can be passed to an audio synthesis engine as disclosed in further detail herein, which audio synthesis engine can use to choose the proper voice for generating the synthesized audio from the story transcript.

[0084] In some cases, receiving a host selection at block **306** can include receiving user input indicative of a host to select at block **308**. Receiving this user input can include receiving a selection of a host or a selection of criteria used to identify a particular host. In some cases, receiving this user input can be in response to presenting a list of available hosts to the user. In some cases, the list of available hosts can be filtered such that only desired hosts are presented to the user for selection. Such filtering can occur automatically, such as to filter out hosts that are not in the user's language (e.g., as identified in the user's preferences) or to filter out hosts that the user does not have permissions to access (e.g., hosts requiring a subscription or prior purchase that the user does not yet have). Filtering can occur manually, such as by allowing the user to select criteria (e.g., sex, genre, style, etc.), which can be used to identify a subset of the available voices, which can be presented to the user for user selection).

[0085] In some cases, receiving a host selection at block **306** can include auto-selecting a host at block **310**. Auto-selecting a host can occur in response to a user input indicative of the user desiring for auto-selection (e.g., tapping an "auto-select host" button) or automatically (e.g., automatically selecting a host by default unless the user decides otherwise). Auto-selecting a host can include accessing criteria used to filter the full list of available hosts into a list of potential hosts. A host can then be selected from the list of potential hosts randomly, pseudo-randomly, or non-randomly (e.g., selecting the host most often used by the user in the past, the host least often used by the user in the past, the host most often used by others, the host having a highest rating, and the like).

[0086] At block **312**, a custom prompt is generated. Generation of a custom prompt can use the POI(s) from block **302**, the host selection from block **306**, and optionally other information, such as user preferences from block **304**. Generating a custom prompt can include leveraging a prompt template to generate a prompt. An example of a basic prompt template could be "Write out a transcript for a spoken-word <<genre>> about <POI>," where <genre> is a genre associated with the host selected at block **306** and <POI> is a POI selected at block **302**. In such an example, if the genre was "historical documentary" and the POI is "Central Park," the custom prompt based on the prompt template may be "Write out a transcript for a spoken-word historical documentary about Central Park." More complex prompt templates can be used.

[0087] In some cases, generating the custom prompt at block **312** includes selecting a prompt template at block **320**. Selecting a prompt template can include selecting a prompt template from a collection of potential prompt templates (e.g., a database of prompt templates) based on desired criteria. In some cases, each prompt template will be associated with a particular criterion, such that the POI selected at block **302** and/or the host selected at block **306** can be used to identify a particular prompt template to use. For example, each genre can be associated with a particular prompt template in the database of prompt templates, such that a genre of "comedy' may result in selection of a first prompt template and a genre of "documentary" may result in selection of a second prompt template. The first prompt template can be written to be especially useful for generating stories of the "comedy" genre (e.g., "Write out a transcript for a spoken-word presentation about <POI> in a friendly and humorous tone, incorporating several short jokes or puns while still providing information about <POI>"), whereas the second prompt template can be written to be especially useful for generating stories of the "documentary" genre (e.g., "Write out a transcript for a spoken-word documentary about <POI>, focusing on a few interesting facts about <POI> that are easy to understand"). In another example, the number of POIs selected can be used as a criterion (e.g., a first prompt template is used when a single POI is selected, but a second prompt template is used when multiple POIs are selected). In another example, different prompt templates can be used for different types of POIs, such as using a first prompt template for restaurants and a second prompt template for museums. Various other criteria can be used in prompt template selection. In some cases, selection of a prompt template can include single-user or multi-user rating information about the prompt template, which can be based one or more ratings of past stories that were generated using that prompt template. For example, if a particular user seems to prefer (e.g., based on user-provided feedback or contextual feedback, such as whether or not the user finishes the whole store and/or whether or not the user replays the story) stories that were generated using one or more particular prompt templates, selecting the prompt template at block **320** can take that preference into account and select a suitable prompt template that is the same as or similar to that one or more particular prompt templates.

[0088] At block **314**, the custom prompt from block **312** is passed to an LLM generative AI. Any suitable LLM generative AI can be used. The LLM generative AI can be trained to generate an AI response in response to receiving an input prompt. By using the custom prompt from block **312** as the input prompt, an AI response can be generated by the LLM generative AI and then received at block **316**. In some cases, the LLM generative AI can be implemented by a third party, in which case passing the custom prompt to the LLM generative AI at block **314** may include accessing an API associated with the LLM generative AI to enable use of the LLM generative AI.

[0089] At block **318** a story transcript is generated based on the AI response from block **316**. In some cases, generating the story transcript is as simple as using the AI response as the story transcript. In some cases, generating the story transcript includes applying simple post-processing to the AI response, such as to remove unnecessary, non-substantive content. In some cases, generating the story transcript can include incorporating additional content into the AI response. For example, additional content can include user-specific content (e.g., adding starting text saying "Hi John" or the like), host-specific content, advertising content, or the like. In an example, when generating a story transcript for a particular POI, a determination can be made that a particular piece of advertising content (e.g., a textual advertisement) should be used (e.g., because the advertising content is associated with the POI) and that piece of advertising content can be combined with the AI response to generate the story transcript (e.g., by adding the advertising content before, after, or within the AI response). After generation, the story transcript can be used as described herein, such as delivery to a user device for presentation to a user and/or in the generation of story audio content.

[0090] While process **300** is described with reference to various blocks in a particular order, in some cases process **300** can include additional blocks, fewer blocks, and/or different blocks, in the same or different orders. For example, in some cases, process **300** may not include block **304**, in which case generating the custom prompt at block **312** occurs without need to access user preferences. In another example, process **300** may not include block **306**, in which case generating the custom prompt at block **312** will occur with a pre-selected or default host without needing to receive a host selection. In another example, instead of passing a custom prompt to an LLM generative AI at block **314**, the custom prompt can be passed to a different type of generative AI. In some cases, some blocks can be merged together or split into additional blocks.

[0091] FIG. **4** is a flowchart depicting a process **400** for dynamically generating story audio content, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. Process **400** can be performed on any suitable computing device or set of computing devices, such as a backend server.

[0092] At block **402**, a story transcript is received. The story transcript can be the story transcript generated by process **300** of FIG. **3**.

[0093] At block **404**, a voice identifier can be received. In some cases, receiving a voice identifier at block **404** can include receiving a voice identifier associated with the selected host from block **306** of process **300** of FIG. **3**. In some cases, receiving a voice identifier at block **404** can include selecting a default voice. In some cases, receiving a voice identifier at block **404** can include otherwise receiving a voice identifier, such as via direct user input (e.g., presenting the user with available voices separate from host selection). Each voice identifier can indicate a particular voice to be used by the audio synthesis engine.

[0094] At block **406**, the voice identifier and the story transcript are passed to an audio synthesis engine. In some cases, the audio synthesis engine is implemented by a third-party, in which case the voice identifier and story transcript may be passed via an API associated with the audio synthesis engine. The audio synthesis engine can be any text-to-speech engine. In some cases, however, the audio synthesis engine is an AI-based text-to-speech engine trained on human voices and capable of producing human-like speech. In response to passing the voice identifier and story transcript to the audio synthesis engine, the audio synthesis engine can generate synthesized audio of the story transcript, as read by the voice associated with the provided voice identifier.

[0095] At block **408**, the synthesized audio from the audio synthesis engine can be received. At block **410**, story audio content can be generated based on the synthesized audio. In some cases, generating the story audio content is as simple as using the synthesized audio as the story audio content. In some cases, generating the story audio content includes applying simple post-processing to the synthesized audio, such as to change encoding, remove unnecessary, non-substantive content, or otherwise process the audio file. In some cases, generating the story audio content can include incorporating additional content into the synthesized audio. For example, additional content can include user-specific content, host-specific content (e.g., adding a starting phrase that is always used with the selected host, such as "Hi, I'm Sarah" or the like), advertising content, or the like. In an example, when generating story audio content for a particular POI, a determination can be made that a particular piece of advertising content (e.g., a pre-recorded advertisement) should be used (e.g., because the advertising content is associated with the POI) and that piece of advertising content can be combined with the synthesized audio to generate the story audio content (e.g., by adding the advertising content before, after, or within the story audio content). After generation, the story audio content can be used as described herein, such as delivery to a user device for presentation to a user and/or storage for future use.

[0096] While process **400** is described with reference to various blocks in a particular order, in some cases process **400** can include additional blocks, fewer blocks, and/or different blocks, in the same or different orders. For example, in some cases, process **400** may not include block **404**, in which case no voice identifier is provided, so the audio synthesis engine may use a random, pseudorandom, or default voice to generate the synthesized audio. In some cases, some blocks can be merged together or split into additional blocks.

[0097] FIG. **5** is a flowchart depicting a process **500** for encouraging follow-up interactions, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0098] At block **502**, story content can be provided for presentation to the user. The story content can include a story transcript (e.g., a story transcript from process **300** of FIG. **3**) and/or story audio content (e.g., story audio content from process **400** of FIG. **4**). Providing the story content for presentation to a user can include transmitting the story content to a user device associated with the user or otherwise making the story content available to the user. Story content can include a story transcript (e.g., a text-based), story audio content (e.g., a text-to-speech synthesized audio file of a story transcript), story-related images or videos (e.g., images or videos of the POI, images or videos of advertising content related to the POI, etc.), and the like.

[0099] In some cases, providing story content for presentation to a user can include automatically presenting the story content to the user. In some cases, providing story content for presentation can include transmitting the story content to a user device for presentation at a later time. Presentation of story content can include presenting the story content through any suitable display device (e.g., smartphone screen), audio device (e.g., earphones or headphones), or the like.

[0100] At block **504**, one or more follow-up prompts can be determined. A follow-up prompt is suggestion that can be presented to a user for a subsequent story that the user may enjoy. A follow-up prompt may take the form of a button or set of buttons identifying other POIs that are suggested for the user, although that need not always be the case. The use of follow-up prompts suggesting one or more additional POIs for story generation allows a user to build a chain of stories. In some cases, by following the follow-up prompts, a user can learn about new places and things that they previously did not know about.

[0101] The follow-up prompt(s) can be based on a POI associated with the story content (e.g., associated with the POI itself or with a location of the POI). The follow-up prompts can give the user an option to request a story that is based on a POI related to the original POI, based on a POI that is related to the location of the original POI, or a POI otherwise related to the original POI. In some cases, the follow-up prompt can further be based on a selected genre (e.g., based on the selected host), such that suggested stories will purposefully have the same genre, or in some optional cases, purposefully have a different genre, than the genre of the initial story content.

[0102] In a first example, after presenting story content to a user that is an architectural history of a first POI that is a particular building in a city, the system may determine that a desirable follow-up prompt would be a prompt suggesting a second POI that is a different building in the city, possibly one with similar or contrasting architecture to the building of the first POI.

[0103] In a second example, after presenting story content to a user about a first POI that is a restaurant, the system may determine that desirable follow-up prompts would be prompts suggesting POIs that are other restaurants located nearby the first POI.

[0104] At block **506**, the follow-up prompt(s) from block **504** can be provided for presentation to a user. For example, the follow-up prompt(s) can be transmitted to a user device for immediate or future presentation to a user. In some cases, providing the follow-up prompt can include providing the follow-up prompt during presentation of a story and/or after completion of a story. In some cases, however, providing a follow-up prompt can occur at the same time as delivery of the story content from which it is based. In some such cases, the follow-up prompt can be included as a separate part of the story content (e.g., the story content would include the story transcript, the story audio content, and the follow-up prompts). In some cases, the one or more follow-up prompts can be incorporated into the story transcript and/or story audio content (e.g., after the main content related to the POI is discussed, the story transcript and/or story audio content can include "After ceasing to use the Patent Office Building at F and 7th in 1932, the United States Patent Office moved to the Herbert Hoover Building for the next 37 years. Press the button below for more information about the Herbert Hoover Building.").

[0105] At block **508**, a follow-up selection can be received. The follow-up selection can be a selection made by the user based on the follow-up prompt. For example, if a follow-up prompt is provided that indicates a particular suggested POI, the follow-up selection can be a transmission initiated by the user indicating that the user wishes to proceed with the POI suggested in the follow-up prompt. In some cases, the follow-up selection is simply a new request to generate story content associated with the suggested POI. In some cases, the follow-up selection can be indicative of multiple POIs, such as indicating a first POI that should be initially played next and a second POI that should be played after the first POI (e.g., added to the chain after the first POI) or that should be saved for a future listening session (e.g., added to a "saved" or "wish list" list of POIs).

[0106] At block **510**, additional story content is generated or retrieved in response to receiving the follow-up selection. The additional story content can be associated with a particular POI, namely the suggested POI from the follow-up prompt selected by the user. Generation of the additional story content can occur similarly to generation of initial story content for an initial POI, but using the suggested POI instead of the initial POI. In some cases, however, story content for the suggested POI may be already stored, in which case the system can merely retrieve the stored additional story content.

[0107] At block **512**, the additional story content can be provided for presentation to the user. Providing the additional story content at block **512** can occur the same as or similarly to providing the initial story content at block **502**, but with the additional story content instead of the initial story content.

[0108] In some cases, process **500** can continue iteratively from block **512** to block **504** to generate chains of stories. In some cases, the chain of stories can be stored for display (e.g., for a user to display to other users the chain they listened to recently) or other future uses (e.g., for a user to share a particular chain of stories with another user). The chain of stories can act as a sort of playlist for story content. In some cases, a user can edit a chain by deleting, adding, or moving stories in the chain.

[0109] While process **500** is described with reference to various blocks in a particular order, in some cases process **500** can include additional blocks, fewer blocks, and/or different blocks, in the same or different orders. In some cases, some blocks can be merged together or split into additional blocks. For example, in some cases when a follow-up prompt is included with the story content, block **504** can occur prior to block **502**, and block **502** can be merged with block **506**. In another example, block **506** can proceed automatically to block **510** without block **508**, such as if the user enables an "autoplay" feature, in which case after a follow-up prompt is presented, the system can automatically proceed, such as after a short delay, with generating and presenting story content for the POI suggested in the follow-up prompt unless the user cancels the action.

[0110] In another example, instead of relying on follow-up prompts, a user can initiate a follow-up request by asking a question or otherwise indicating a desire for more information on the given POI or a different POI. In such cases, block **504** and block **506** can be removed and the follow-up selection from block **508** can be a follow-up request that was initiated by the user.

[0111] FIG. **6** is a chart depicting a story content generation workflow **600**, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The story content generation workflow **600** can proceed the same as or similarly to process **300** of FIG. **3**.

[0112] The story content generation workflow **600** shows actions between a mobile app **602** (e.g., running on a user device), a user backend **604** (e.g., running on a first server), an AI backend **606** (e.g., running on the first server or a second server), and a database **608** (e.g., communicatively coupled to the user backend **604**).

[0113] Initially, the mobile app **602** can send communication **610**, which can be a user request containing various information usable to generate story content. For example, the user request can include an identifier associated with the user, host selection information, POI selection information, and optional user preferences.

[0114] Upon receiving the communication **610**, the user backend **604** can create a custom prompt (e.g., by selecting a prompt template and generating the custom prompt) and send, to the AI backend **606**, a communication **612** that is a story content generation request. The story content generation request can include the custom prompt and any other information needed by the AI backend **606** to generate the story content (e.g., a voice identifier).

[0115] Upon receiving the communication **612**, the AI backend **606** can generate story content at action **614**. Generating the story content at action **614** can include sending a communication from the AI backend **606** to one or more other servers (not depicted) via one or more APIs as disclosed in further detail herein. For example, the AI backend **606** can send a communication that includes the custom prompt to a first AI server, which, upon receiving the custom prompt, generates an AI response and sends it back to the AI backend **606**. The AI backend **606** can generate the story transcript from the AI response. The AI backend **606** can send a second communication that includes the story transcript to a second AI server, which, upon receiving the story transcript, generates synthesized audio and sends it back to the AI backend **606**. The AI backend **606** can generate story audio content from the synthesized audio. The AI backend **606** can generate (e.g., compile) story content from the story transcript and the story audio content. The AI backend **606** can then send the story content to the user backend **604** by sending communication **616** to the user backend **604**.

[0116] The user backend **604** can optionally store the received story content by sending a communication **618** to the database **608** that includes the story content and optionally other metadata (e.g., inputs and/or prompt used to generate the story content). The database **608** can store the story content for future use. In some cases, the database **608** can send communication **620** back to user backend **604** as a confirmation that the data has been stored.

[0117] The user backend **604**, in response to communication **616**, can send the story content to the mobile app **602** via communication **622**. Once received, the story content can be automatically presented and/or optionally stored for future use.

[0118] While described with certain features and communications, story content generation workflow **600** may include additional, fewer, and/or different features and communications. For example, in some cases the user backend **604** and AI backend **606** can be integrated together, thus eliminating the need for communication **612** and communication **616**. In another example, the communication **612** can be split into multiple communications, such as a first communication for the story transcript and a second communication for the story audio content.

[0119] FIG. **7** is a chart depicting a follow-up content generation workflow **700**, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The story follow-up content generation workflow **700** can proceed similarly to process **500** of FIG. **5** when a follow-up request is initiated by the user.

[0120] The story follow-up content generation workflow **700** shows actions between a mobile app **702** (e.g., running on a user device), a user backend **704** (e.g., running on a first server), an AI backend **706** (e.g., running on the first server or a second server), and a database **708** (e.g., communicatively coupled to the user backend **704**).

[0121] The mobile app **702** can receive input form the user indicative of a request for more information. For example, the user may tap an interactive button, may type in a question, may speak a question, or may otherwise interact with the mobile app **702** to determine a request for more information. The mobile app **702** can send this follow-up request to the user backend **704** via communication **710**.

[0122] The follow-up request can be a user-initiated request (e.g., created entirely by the user) or a follow-up selection (e.g., a selection of POIs made in response to a follow-up prompt).

[0123] The user backend **704**, upon receiving the communication **710**, can send a follow-up request to the AI backend **706** via communication **712**. In some cases, the user backend **704** can convert the follow-up request as sent via the mobile app **702** into a format that is more understandable or usable for generation of follow-up content. For example, in some cases the user backend **704** can select a prompt template and generate a custom prompt using the follow-up request.

[0124] The AI backend **706** can generate, at action **714**, follow-up content similarly to how it generates initial story content, such as described with reference to AI backend **606** of FIG. **6** but using the follow-up request from the user backend **704**. Once the follow-up content is generated, the AI backend **706** can sent it to the user backend **704** via communication **716**.

[0125] Upon receiving the communication **716**, the user backend **704** can transmit the follow-up content to the mobile app **702** via communication **718**. Once received, the follow-up content can be automatically presented and/or optionally stored for future use.

[0126] While described with certain features and communications, follow-up content generation workflow **700** may include additional, fewer, and/or different features and communications. For example, in some cases the user backend **704** and AI backend **706** can be integrated together, thus eliminating the need for communication **712** and communication **716**. In another example, upon receiving the communication **716**, the user backend **704** can optionally send the follow-up content to the database **708** via a communication. The database **708** can then optionally send a response back to the user backend **704** indicating that the follow-up content was stored. In some cases, follow-up content can be stored in association with the story content from which it originated.

[0127] FIG. **8** is a chart depicting a social interaction workflow **800** and a story chain management workflow **801**, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure.

[0128] In some cases, the system can include social features, such as the ability to post and share stories that one has generated, the ability to curate chains or playlists of stories, the ability to comment on another's posts or stories, the ability to suggest edits or corrections to story content (e.g., edits to story transcripts to correct an AI hallucinations or edits to story audio content to correct mispronunciations). These various social features can be enabled by the mobile app **802** (e.g., to receive user input to initiate social interaction actions), the user backend **804** (e.g., to carry out social interaction actions), and the database **808** (e.g., to store social interaction data). A social interaction is an interaction with a social feature. A social interaction action is an action taken to effect the social interaction. Examples of social interactions include managing friends (e.g., managing followers, managing individuals followed), sharing stories (e.g., sharing individual stories, sharing chains of stories, sharing comments on stories, etc.), generating or managing posts (e.g., posts to the user's own feed or to a feed of another user), and the like.

[0129] The mobile app **802** can, in response to receiving input from the user to initiate a social interaction action, transmit a communication **810** to the user backend **804**, which is an instruction to initiate a social interaction action.

[0130] Upon receiving the communication **810**, the user backend **804** can carry out the social interaction action by sending communication **812** to a database **808** in which the social interaction data is stored. The social interaction action can result in a change to the database **808**, such as to add new information (e.g., add a new post about a story), remove information (e.g., delete a selected story from a chain of stories), or otherwise modify information (e.g., replace a cover art image for a story with a different image). For example, a user initiating a social interaction that is adding a new individual as a "friend" on the platform can include adding an entry to the user's list of friends that contains an identifier of the new individual.

[0131] In some cases, the mobile app **802**, user backend **804**, and database **808** can be used to enable the generation and management of story chains.

[0132] In response to the mobile app **802** receiving input from a user to create and/or manage a story chain, the mobile app **802** can transmit a communication **814** to user backend **804** to create and/or manage a story chain.

[0133] Upon receiving the communication **814**, the user backend **804** can send a communication **816** to the database **808** to take an action that results in the creation or management of a story chain. This communication **816** can include story chain information, such as an identifier for the story chain, a user-readable name for the story chain, a list of stories included on the story chain, a description of the story chain, an indication of one or more hosts associated with the story chain, and the like. When a story chain is created, the story chain information can be stored in the database **808**. The database **808** can be accessed to access the story chain.

[0134] While described with certain features and communications, the social interaction workflow **800** and story chain management workflow **801** may each include additional, fewer, and/or different features and communications. For example, in some cases a user may instruct the system to auto-generate a description for a story chain containing multiple stories, in which case the user backend **804** may interact with and otherwise send communications to and receive communications from the AI backend **818** to automatically generate a description of the story chain. This description may be auto-generated by the AI backend **818** passing information about the stories within the story chain to an LLM generative AI, which can output a suitable description. In such cases, the user backend **804** or AI backend **818** may select a prompt template and generate a custom prompt specifically for generation of a story chain description.

[0135] FIG. **9** is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for general startup and POI selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). The GUIs can include a welcome screen **902**, a home interface **904**, and a POI interface **906**.

[0136] The welcome screen **902** can present the user with information about the mobile app in general, such as a name, logo, and the like. In some cases, after presenting the welcome screen **902**, the system can present the home interface **904**.

[0137] The home interface **904** can present the user with various information and features, such as information about the current user, options to access user preferences, app settings, social interactions, and past stories. The home interface **904** can also include a map **908** (e.g., a map initially centered on the user's current location) that displays a number of POIs **910**. In some cases, the POIs **910** displayed are a subset of all available nearby POIs after being filtered (e.g., filtered by currently selected host, which can also be displayed on the home interface **904**). The home interface **904** may also include an auto-select button **912**, here labeled "Surprise Me!" The user can interact with the home interface **904**, such as by tapping on a POI **910** to select a particular POI for story generation or by tapping the auto-select button **912** to have a POI auto-selected for story generation.

[0138] Once a POI is selected, the mobile app can present a POI interface **906**. The POI interface **906** can present information about a particular POI in a POI information screen **914**. The POI information screen **914** can include information such as an image or video of the POI, a name of the POI, an address of the POI, and/or other such information). The POI information screen **914** can also include a more information button **916**, which can be pressed by the user to generate a story for the user based on the POI.

[0139] FIG. **10** is a screenshot depicting an alternate GUI for POI selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). The GUI can include a home interface **1002** that is an alternate version of the home interface **904** of FIG. **9**. In addition to various design differences, the home interface **1002** includes a POI indicator **1004** that takes the form of a rabbit logo. This unique POI indicator **1004** can help differentiate selectable POIs from other POIs that may otherwise appear on the map (e.g., nearby stores, metro stops, etc.). The home interface **1002** can also include a recent activity section as described in further detail in FIG. **16**.

[0140] FIG. **11** is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for story playback, activity information, and user preferences, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). The GUIs can include a player interface **1102**, an activity interface **1104**, and a preference interface **1106**.

[0141] Once a story is generated, it can be presented to a user, such as via a player interface **1102**. The player interface **1102** can show an image associated with the story (e.g., an image of the host narrating the story). The player interface **1102** can display a title associated with the story, which can be generated as part of the generated story content (e.g., generated as part of or along with the story transcript). The player interface **1102** can display narrator information, such as a name and/or image of the narrator. The player interface **1102** can display a user's progress in the story, such as by displaying a count-up or count-down timer, displaying a progress bar, or otherwise providing information to the user about the progress within the story. In some cases, the player interface **1102** can display an indicator that the story audio content is being played, which in some cases can be a changing count-up or count-down timer. In some cases, the player interface **1102** can include controls to control story playback, such as a stop button, a pause button, a speed control (e.g., to slightly increase or decrease playback speed), and the like. Other features can be used on the player interface **1102**.

[0142] After a story is presented, the user can be presented with an activity interface **1104**. The activity interface **1104** can show the story that was just completed, optionally also showing previously completed stories, and can then show one or more follow-up prompts. As depicted in FIG. **11**, the follow-up prompts can take the form of an ordered list of stories from which the user can select an individual story for playback or can select a "play all" option to play through all stories in the order of the ordered list. As depicted in FIG. **11**, the first follow-up option is a "surprise me" story that has been or will be auto-generated by the platform; the second follow-up prompt is shown as a story about an individual associated with a POI (e.g., such as an individual mentioned in the recently-presented story or in an earlier story on the ordered list); and the third follow-up prompt is shown as a story about a location.

[0143] When a user wishes to set up their user preferences, they can access a preference interface **1106**. The preference interface **1106** can show and permit editing of the user's profile, which can be displayed to others as part of the social features of the platform. The preference interface **1106** can allow the user to set various user preferences, such as selecting their desired genres or topics, selecting their desired hosts, and the like. These user preferences can be especially useful in automatically generating stories (e.g., through a POI auto-select feature).

[0144] FIGS. **12A-12C** are portions of a diagram depicting available story hosts, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The diagram depicts host options **1200**, which may include all possible hosts or a subset of available hosts (e.g., filtered by language or genres).

[0145] Each host can be presented with topic information **1202** and a host information card **1210**. The topic information **1202** can include information about a topic or primary genre associated with the host and a general description of that topic/genre.

[0146] The host information card **1210** can include various information about the user themselves, such as a host image **1204**, a host description **1206**, and host tags **1208**. The host description **1206** can provide information about the host, which can inform a user as to how that host is likely to present information. Additionally, host tags **1208** can identify genres and sub-genres associated with the host, including those other than the primary genre associated with the host. For example, a host may be primarily associated with news, but may also be associated with culture and engineering. In some cases, host tags **1208** can include tags other than just genres or sub-genres.

[0147] FIGS. **13A-13B** are a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for host selection and initial POI selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). The GUIs can include a host suggestion interface **1302**, a selection interface **1304**, and a start interface **1306**.

[0148] The system can help the user select a desired host. A selection interface **1304** can be presented, giving the user an option to select various options **1308** (e.g., desired genres) that are of interest to the user. The system can then take the user's selected options, and optionally other user preference information, and identify a particular host who may be a good fit for the user (e.g., matches the most of the user's options).

[0149] In some cases, after a host is selected, the system can provide a prompt to select a POI for story generation via a selection interface **1304**. The selection interface **1304** can provide the user with a map option **1310** and an auto-select option **1312**. Upon selecting the map option **1310**, a user may be presented with a map showing various potential POIs, each of which can be selected by the user for story generation. Upon selecting the auto-select option **1312**, the system can automatically identify a POI from which to generate a story.

[0150] After a POI has been selected, the system can present a start interface **1306**. The start interface **1306** can include a start button which can be engaged by the user to commence playback of the story. In some cases, the start interface **1306** can include additional information of interest to the user, such as information about how the user will be presented with one or more follow-up prompts upon completion of the story.

[0151] FIG. **14** is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for social interactions, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). The GUIs can include a social interface **1402** and a social interface **1404**.

[0152] The social interface **1402** can show social interaction information associated with the user, such as individuals they are currently following, individuals the user may be interested in following, and individuals following the user. The social interface **1402** can give the user options to follow and unfollow users, as well as other options.

[0153] In some cases, such as if the user is not yet following anyone, the social interface **1404** can be presented showing individuals they may be interested in following.

[0154] FIGS. **15**A-**15**E are sets of screenshots depicting GUI screens for story host selection, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. In some cases, selecting a host can include selecting a genre. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). Information can be provided for each host, such as via a host-specific selection screen, although that need not always be the case.

[0155] In an example, on an adventure guide host screen **1502**, the user can be presented with a host name **1512** (e.g., "Architecture Guide"), a host description **1514** (e.g., "Explore the world of architecture and urban design that surrounds you. Discover the hidden influential figures of the world of architecture and the cultural influences that inspire them. Our guide will expose you to the historical significance of notable buildings and urban spaces to help you understand and look more closely at your surroundings"), one or more host tags **1516** (e.g., "Architecture," "Buildings," "Design"). In some cases, other information can be provided. When selected, the story to be generated can be generated using a prompt template associated with the given genre (e.g., "Architecture Guide") and a voice predetermined to be associated with that host (e.g., a particular voice identifier used for the Architecture Guide or a selection from a limited list of voice identifiers used for the Architecture Guide).

[0156] Examples of free hosts can include an adventure guide host (e.g., via adventure guide host screen **1502**), an art guide host (e.g., via art guide host screen **1504**), a foodie guide host (e.g., via foodie guide host screen **1506**), a music guide host (e.g., via music guide host screen **1508**), a true crime guide host (e.g., via true crime guide host screen **1526**), a paranormal guide host (e.g., via paranormal guide host screen **1524**), a sports guide host (e.g., via sports guide host screen **1522**), a film and TV guide host (e.g., via film and TV guide host screen **1520**), a kid's guide host (e.g., via kid's guide host screen **1532**), a weather history guide host (e.g., via weather history guide host screen **1530**), and a nature guide host (e.g., via nature guide host screen **1528**). Other hosts can be included additionally or instead of those hosts depicted in FIGS. **15**A-**15**E.

[0157] In some cases, a user can select between free hosts and premium hosts. As depicted in FIGS. **15**A-**15**E, the free or premium host selection is currently set to "Free"," Free hosts may be freely available to all users, whereas access to premium hosts may be provided only to users with requisite permissions, such as users that have purchased access to premium hosts, users who pay a subscription fee, users who have participated with the platform (e.g., used the platform generally and/or socially shared content via or from the platform) a requisite amount, users provided with an access code to access one or more specific premium hosts (e.g., access to premium hosts associated with a movie may be provided through use of an access code given to individuals who purchased tickets to see the movie), and users who are part of a particular group (e.g., members of an organization may be provided with access to premium hosts associated with that organization).

[0158] In some cases, a premium host can be associated with the same genre as a free host (e.g., a free host version of "Architecture Guide" and a premium host version of "Architecture Guide"). In some cases, the free host version may be a generic guide whereas the premium version is a guide for the same genre, but based on a specific person, whether real or fictional. In an example, for the true crime genre, the free host version may be a generic true crime guide, whereas the premium version may be based on Candice DeLong, a former FBI criminal profiler, best-selling author, and popular podcaster.

[0159] In some cases, the list of premium hosts can include additional genres other than those available in the list of free hosts. For example, the list of free hosts can include a Cynical Guide, a Monster Guide, A Fantasy Guide, and an ASMR (autonomous sensory meridian response) Guide. In some cases, a premium guide can be based on a specific person or persona, whether real or fictional.

[0160] The various hosts discussed with reference to FIGS. **15**A-**15**E can be the same or similar to hosts and/or topics as discussed with reference to FIGS. **12**A-**12**C.

[0161] FIG. **16** is a set of screenshots depicting GUIs for social interaction, according to certain aspects of the present disclosure. The screenshots can be displayed on a user device (e.g., a smartphone). The GUIs can include a social activity screen **1602** and a past stories screen **1604**.

[0162] The social activity screen **1602** can include a listing of social activity in the form of social activity entries **1608**. In some cases, the social activity screen **1602** is designed to show only recent social activity of the user themselves, such as entry social activity entries **1608** published by the user viewing the social activity screen **1602**. In some cases, the social activity screen **1602** can show recent social activity of a selected user (e.g., another user). In some cases, the social activity screen **1602** can show the recent social activity of anyone that the given user is following (e.g., multiple other users).

[0163] Each social activity entry **1608** can provide information about a story associated with the user who published the social activity entry **1608**, such as (i) a story that user recently completed; (ii) a story that user recently started listening to; (iii) a story that user selected to publish; or (iv) any combination of (i)-(iii).

[0164] In some cases, each social activity entry **1608** can be associated specifically a story whose generation was initiated at the publishing user's request (e.g., the user selected the host and POI, or the user engaged an auto-select feature), although that need not always be the case. In some cases, the recent activity can include a social activity entry **1608** that is based on a story whose generation was initiated by another user, such as a story previously published by another user but listened to (and optionally further shared) by the currently publishing user.

[0165] The social activity entry **1608** can include information about the story, such as a title (e.g., a user-provided or auto-generated title), a POI information (e.g., a name or location), host information (e.g., a genre, voice, etc.), timestamp information (e.g., timestamp information for generation of the story; timestamp information for when the user listened to the story; and/or timestamp information for when the user published the social activity entry **1608**), and the like. In some cases, each social activity entry **1608** can give an option for another user to engage with the social activity entry **1608**, such as by liking (e.g., clicking a heart icon), commenting on (e.g., by clicking a speech bubble icon), or sharing (e.g., by clicking on a paper airplane icon) the story and/or social activity entry **1608**. In some cases, the social activity entry **1608** includes an indication of the user who published the social activity entry **1608**.

[0166] The past stories screen **1604** can show a listing of a user's own past stories, which can include stories that have been generated and/or stories to which the user has listened or started to listen. In some cases, the user can select a story to listen to it again and/or to share or publish the stories (e.g., share or publish to their social activity feed, such as to appear on the social activity screen **1602** of other users who follow the given user). In some cases, the past stories screen **1604** can provide a filter to filter out stories in the list, such as to show only "new" stories or to show only "published" stories.

[0167] FIG. **17** is a block diagram of an example system architecture **1702** for implementing features and processes of the present disclosure, such as those presented with reference to processes **200**, **300**, **400**, and **500** of FIGS. **2**, **3**, **4**, and **5**, respectively. The features and processes disclosed herein can be implemented using one or multiple instances of **1702**. The system architecture **1702** can be used to implement a server (e.g., a cloud-accessible server), a user device (e.g., a smartphone or personal computer), or any other suitable device for performing some or all of the aspects of the present disclosure. The system architecture **1702** can be implemented on any electronic device that runs software applications derived from compiled instructions, including without limitation personal computers, servers, smart phones, electronic tablets, game consoles, email devices, and the like. In some implementations, the system architecture **1702** can include one or more processors **1706**, one or more input devices **1714**, one or more display devices **1712**, one or more network interfaces **1710**, and one or more computer-readable media **1722**. Each of these components can be coupled by bus **1720**.

[0168] Display device **1712** can be any known display technology, including but not limited to display devices using Liquid Crystal Display (LCD) or Light Emitting Diode (LED) technology. Processor(s) **802** can use any known processor technology, including but not limited to graphics processors and multi-core processors. Input device **1714** can be any known input device technology, including but not limited to a keyboard (including a virtual keyboard), mouse, track ball, and touch-sensitive pad or display. In some cases, audio inputs can be used to provide audio signals, such as audio signals of an individual speaking. Bus **1720** can be any known internal or external bus technology, including but not limited to ISA, EISA, PCI, PCI Express, NuBus, USB, Serial ATA or Fire Wire.

[0169] Computer-readable medium **1722** can be any medium that participates in providing instructions to processor **1706** for execution, including without limitation, non-volatile storage media (e.g., optical disks, magnetic disks, flash drives, etc.) or volatile media (e.g., SDRAM, ROM, etc.). The computer-readable medium (e.g., storage devices, mediums, and memories) can include, for example, a cable or wireless signal containing a bit stream and the like. However, when mentioned, non-transitory computer-readable storage media expressly exclude media such as energy, carrier signals, electromagnetic waves, and signals per se.

[0170] Computer-readable medium **1722** can include various instructions for implementing operating system **1716** and applications **1718** such as computer programs. The operating system **1716** can be multi-user, multiprocessing, multitasking, multithreading, real-time and the like. The operating system **1716** performs basic tasks, including but not limited to: recognizing input from input device **1714**; sending output to display device **1712**; keeping track of files and directories on computer-readable medium **1722**; controlling peripheral devices (e.g., storage drives, interface devices, etc.) which can be controlled directly or through an I/O controller; and managing traffic on bus **1720**. Computer-readable medium **1722** can include various instructions for implementing firmware processes, such as a BIOS. Computer-readable medium **1722** can include various instructions for implementing any of the processes described herein, including at least processes **200**, **300**, **400**, and **500** of FIGS. **2**, **3**, **4**, and **5**, respectively.

[0171] Memory **1708** can include high-speed random access memory and/or non-volatile memory, such as one or more magnetic disk storage devices, one or more optical storage devices, and/or flash memory (e.g., NAND, NOR). The memory **1708** (e.g., computer-readable storage devices, mediums, and memories) can include a cable or wireless signal containing a bit stream and the like. However, when mentioned, non-transitory computer-readable storage media expressly exclude media such as energy, carrier signals, electromagnetic waves, and signals per se. The memory **1708** can store an operating system, such as Darwin, RTXC, LINUX, UNIX, OS X, WINDOWS, or an embedded operating system such as VxWorks.

[0172] System controller **1704** can be a service processor that operates independently of processor **1706**. In some implementations, system controller **1704** can be a baseboard management controller (BMC). For example, a BMC is a specialized service processor that monitors the physical state of a computer, network server, or other hardware device using sensors and communicating with the system administrator through an independent connection. The BMC is configured on the motherboard or main circuit board of the device to be monitored. The sensors of a BMC can measure internal physical variables such as temperature, humidity, power-supply voltage, fan speeds, communications parameters and operating system (OS) functions.

[0173] The described features can be implemented advantageously in one or more computer programs that are executable on a programmable system including at least one programmable processor coupled to receive data and instructions from, and to transmit data and instructions to, a data storage system, at least one input device, and at least one output device. A computer program is a set of instructions that can be used, directly or indirectly, in a computer to perform a certain activity or bring about a certain result. A computer program can be written in any form of programming language (e.g., Objective-C, Java), including compiled or interpreted languages, and it can be deployed in any form, including as a stand-alone program or as a module, component, subroutine, or other unit suitable for use in a computing environment.

[0174] Suitable processors for the execution of a program of instructions include, by way of example, both general and special purpose microprocessors, and the sole processor or one of multiple processors or cores, of any kind of computer. Generally, a processor will receive instructions and data from a read-only memory or a random access memory or both. The essential elements of a computer are a processor for executing instructions and one or more memories for storing instructions and data. Generally, a computer will also include, or be operatively coupled to communicate with, one or more mass storage devices for storing data files; such devices include magnetic disks, such as internal hard disks and removable disks; magneto-optical disks; and optical disks. Storage devices suitable for tangibly embodying computer program instructions and data include all forms of non-volatile memory, including by way of example semiconductor memory devices, such as EPROM, EEPROM, and flash memory devices; magnetic disks such as internal hard disks and removable disks; magneto-optical disks; and CD-ROM and DVD-ROM disks. The processor and the memory can be supplemented by, or incorporated in, ASICs (application-specific integrated circuits).

[0175] To provide for interaction with a user, the features can be implemented on a computer having a display device such as a CRT (cathode ray tube) or LCD (liquid crystal display) monitor for displaying information to the user and a keyboard and a pointing device such as a mouse or a trackball by which the user can provide input to the computer.

[0176] The features can be implemented in a computing system that includes a back-end component, such as a data server, or that includes a middleware component, such as an application server or an Internet server, or that includes a front-end component, such as a client computer having a graphical user interface or an Internet browser, or any combination thereof. The components of the system can be connected by any form or medium of digital data communication such as a communication network. Examples of communication networks include, e.g., a LAN, a WAN, and the computers and networks forming the Internet.

[0177] The computing system can include clients and servers. A client and server are generally remote from each other and typically interact through a network. The relationship of client and server arises by virtue of computer programs running on the respective computers and having a client-server relationship to each other.

[0178] One or more features or steps of the disclosed embodiments can be implemented using an application programming interface (API). An API can define one or more parameters that are passed between a calling application and other software code (e.g., an operating system, library routine, function) that provides a service, that provides data, or that performs an operation or a computation.

[0179] The API can be implemented as one or more calls in program code that send or receive one or more parameters through a parameter list or other structure based on a call convention defined in an API specification document. A parameter can be a constant, a key, a data structure, an object, an object class, a variable, a data type, a pointer, an array, a list, or another call. API calls and parameters can be implemented in any programming language. The programming language can define the vocabulary and calling convention that a programmer will employ to access functions supporting the API.

[0180] In some implementations, an API call can report to an application the capabilities of a device running the application, such as input capability, output capability, processing capability, power capability, communications capability, and the like.

[0181] The foregoing description of the embodiments, including illustrated embodiments, has been presented only for the purpose of illustration and description and is not intended to be exhaustive or limiting to the precise forms disclosed. Numerous modifications, adaptations, and uses thereof will be apparent to those skilled in the art. Numerous changes to the disclosed embodiments can be made in accordance with the disclosure herein, without departing from the spirit or scope of the disclosure. Thus, the breadth and scope of the present disclosure should not be limited by any of the above described embodiments.

[0182] Although certain aspects and features of the present disclosure have been illustrated and described with respect to one or more implementations, equivalent alterations and modifications will occur or be known to others skilled in the art upon the reading and understanding of this specification and the annexed drawings. In addition, while a particular feature may have been disclosed with respect to only one of several implementations, such feature may be combined with one or more other features of the other implementations as may be desired and advantageous for any given or particular application.

[0183] The terminology used herein is for the purpose of describing particular embodiments only, and is not intended to be limiting of the disclosure. As used herein, the singular forms "a," "an," and "the" are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. Furthermore, to the extent that the terms "including," "includes," "having," "has," "with," or variants thereof, are used in either the detailed description and/or the claims, such terms are intended to be inclusive in a manner similar to the term "comprising."

[0184] One or more elements or aspects or steps, or any portion(s) thereof, from one or more of any of the claims below can be combined with one or more elements or aspects or steps, or any portion(s) thereof, from one or more of any of the other claims below or combinations thereof, to form one or more additional implementations and/or claims of the present disclosure.

1. A computer-implemented method, comprising:

receiving location information associated with a user;

identifying one or more points of interest (POIs) based at least in part on the location information;

receiving a story host selection;

dynamically generating story content based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs and the story host selection, wherein dynamically generating the story content includes:

generating a story transcript based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs, generating the story transcript including:

preparing a custom prompt based at least in part on the identified one or more POIs;
passing the custom prompt to a large language model (LLM) generative artificial intelligence (AI); and
receiving an AI response from the LLM generative AI, the story transcript being based at least in part on the AI response;
generating story audio content based at least in part on the story transcript and the story host selection, the story host selection being indicative of a selected voice out of a plurality of available voices for generation of audio content from text, the story audio content being generated using the selected voice; and
providing the story content for presentation to the user, wherein providing the story content to the user includes initiating playback of the generated story audio content.

2. (canceled)

3. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein generating the story transcript is further based at least in part on the story host selection, the story host selection being indicative of a story theme, and wherein preparing the custom prompt is further based at least in part on the story theme.

4. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein the story host selection is indicative of a voice identifier,
wherein generating the story audio content includes:
passing the voice identifier and the story transcript to an artificial intelligence (AI) audio synthesis engine, the voice identifier being indicative of the selected voice; and
receiving synthesized audio in response to passing the voice identifier and the story transcript, the story audio content being based at least in part on the synthesized audio.

5. (canceled)

6. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein preparing the custom prompt is further based at least in part on one or more preferences associated with the user.

7. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein preparing the custom prompt includes selecting a prompt template from a plurality of prompt templates, and wherein the custom prompt is based at least in part on the selected prompt template.

8. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein the location information includes a location name, and wherein preparing the custom prompt is further based at least in part on the location name.

9. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, further comprising identifying one or more advertisement vendors associated with the location information or the one or more POIs, wherein preparing the custom prompt is based at least in part on the one or more advertisement vendors such that the AI response includes content associated with the one or more advertisement vendors.

10. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, further comprising identifying one or more advertisements associated with the location information or the one or more POIs, wherein generating the story transcript includes combining the one or more advertisements with at least a portion of the AI response to create the story transcript.

11. (canceled)

12. The computer-implemented method of claim **4**, further comprising identifying one or more audio advertisements associated with the location information or the one or more POIs, wherein generating the story audio content includes combining the one or more audio advertisements with at least a portion of the synthesized audio to create the story audio content.

13. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein receiving the location information includes:
receiving GPS coordinates associated with a user device of the user; and
determining the location information based at least in part on the GPS coordinates.

14. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, where identifying the one or more POIs includes receiving a user POI selection indicative of at least one POI of the one or more POIs.

15. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, further comprising receiving one or more camera images associated with a user device of the user, wherein identifying the one or more POIs is based at least in part on the one or more camera images.

16. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, further comprising storing the dynamically generated story content for later use.

17. The computer-implemented method of claim **16**, further comprising generating a shareable URL associated with the stored story content, wherein the URL, when accessed by an additional user, causes the stored story content to be provided to the additional user.

18. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein providing the story content for presentation to the user includes providing one or more follow-up prompts for presentation to the user following presentation of the story content.

19. A system comprising:
a control system including one or more processors; and
a memory having stored thereon machine readable instructions;
wherein the control system is coupled to the memory, and the method of claim **1** is implemented when the machine executable instructions in the memory are executed by at least one of the one or more processors of the control system.

20. A computer program product embodied on a non-transitory computer-readable medium and comprising instructions which, when executed by a computer, cause the computer to carry out the method of claim **1**.

21. The computer-implemented method of claim **7**, wherein selecting the prompt template from the plurality of prompt templates is based at least in part on the story host selection, the story host selection being indicative of the selected prompt template.

22. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein passing the custom prompt to the LLM generative AI includes passing the custom prompt via an application programming interface (API) associated with the LLM generative AI.

23. The computer-implemented method of claim **1**, wherein generating the story audio content includes passing the story transcript to an audio synthesis engine, wherein the audio synthesis engine is an AI-based text-to-speech engine, the AI-based text-to-speech engine being trained on human voices such that, when provided with input text, the AI-based text-to-speech engine outputs audio data representative of human-like speech.

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